

RHEINISCH-WESTFÄLISCHE TECHNISCHE HOCHSCHULE AACHEN

INSTITUT FÜR PHYSIKALISCHE CHEMIE

# A Machine Learning Model for the Prediction of Hessian Matrices based on atom based quantities.

Constructing and Testing a Machine Learning Model on a Small Data Set with Systems of Two to Four Atomic Molecules for Exploratory Investigations

Research Internship Report

submitted by

**Gereon Feldmann**

presented to the

Mathematisch-Naturwissenschaftlichen Fakultät der  
Rheinisch-Westfälischen Technischen Hochschule Aachen

Aachen, June 2022

# Contents

|                                                                 |           |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| List of Figures                                                 | iii       |
| List of Tables                                                  | iii       |
| List of Abbreviations                                           | iii       |
| <b>1 Motivation</b>                                             | <b>1</b>  |
| <b>2 Theory</b>                                                 | <b>2</b>  |
| 2.1 Euler Angles . . . . .                                      | 2         |
| 2.2 Electronic Structure Theory . . . . .                       | 4         |
| 2.2.1 Hartree–Fock Model . . . . .                              | 4         |
| 2.2.2 Kohn–Sham Density Functional Theory . . . . .             | 6         |
| 2.2.3 GFN2–xTB Electronic Structure Method . . . . .            | 7         |
| 2.3 Hessian Matrices . . . . .                                  | 9         |
| 2.4 Machine Learning . . . . .                                  | 11        |
| <b>3 Methods</b>                                                | <b>13</b> |
| 3.1 Transformation of Coordinates . . . . .                     | 13        |
| 3.2 ML Model Construction . . . . .                             | 18        |
| 3.3 Quantities for Measuring . . . . .                          | 19        |
| 3.4 Computational Methods . . . . .                             | 20        |
| <b>4 Results and Discussion</b>                                 | <b>22</b> |
| 4.1 The ML Models and Data Set . . . . .                        | 22        |
| 4.2 Feature–Target Correlation . . . . .                        | 23        |
| 4.3 The H <sub>2</sub> system . . . . .                         | 26        |
| 4.4 Comparison of RFR and ETR . . . . .                         | 27        |
| 4.5 Comparison of Permutation Model and Indexed Model . . . . . | 29        |
| 4.6 Benchmarking with the H <sub>3</sub> system . . . . .       | 31        |
| <b>5 Conclusion &amp; Outlook</b>                               | <b>33</b> |
| <b>6 Bibliography</b>                                           | <b>34</b> |



## List of Figures

|     |                                                                                         |    |
|-----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|
| 2.1 | Depiction of two Coordinate systems for description of Euler Angles. . . . .            | 3  |
| 2.2 | Structure of a CART split and its resulting Decision Tree . . . . .                     | 11 |
| 4.1 | Pearson Correlation Coefficient for the ten most important features. . . . .            | 23 |
| 4.2 | Best Pearson Correlation Coefficient computed element wise. . . . .                     | 24 |
| 4.3 | Comparison of wave numbers from GFN2-xTB and the ML model. . . . .                      | 26 |
| 4.4 | Learning plots of the ETR and RFR for an increasing size of the training set . . . . .  | 27 |
| 4.5 | Learning plot for Hessian elements with an increase of randomness on $x$ . . . . .      | 28 |
| 4.6 | Gaussian type Distribution for the prediction of Hessian elements. . . . .              | 29 |
| 4.7 | Error Distribution for the prediction of wave numbers. . . . .                          | 30 |
| 4.8 | Force constants from the indexed multimodel and GFN2-xTB for the $H_3$ system . . .     | 31 |
| 4.9 | Force constants from the permuted multimodel and GFN2-xTB for the $H_3$ system . .      | 32 |
| 7.1 | Gaussian type distribution for the prediction of weighted projected Hessian elements. . | 36 |
| 7.2 | Gaussian type distribution for the prediction of projected Hessian elements. . . . .    | 37 |
| 7.3 | Gaussian type distribution for the prediction of zero point energy. . . . .             | 38 |
| 7.4 | Pearson Correlation Coefficient for the ten most important features (Gen-Perm model). . | 39 |
| 7.5 | Best Pearson Correlation Coefficient computed element wise (Gen-Perm model). . .        | 40 |

## List of Tables

|     |                                                                           |    |
|-----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|
| 3.1 | List of Quantities used for the ML model features. . . . .                | 18 |
| 3.2 | List of Python models used. . . . .                                       | 21 |
| 7.1 | List of indices used for the differentiation of Hessian elements. . . . . | 43 |

# List of Abbreviations

|        |                                     |
|--------|-------------------------------------|
| APF    | Atom Pair Focused                   |
| BO     | Born–Oppenheimer                    |
| Case   | Case-specific                       |
| CART   | Classification and Regression Tree  |
| CS     | Coordinate System                   |
| DFT    | Density Functional Theory           |
| DFTB   | Density Functional Tight Binding    |
| ETR    | Extra Tree Regression               |
| ES     | Electrostatic                       |
| Gen    | General                             |
| HVF    | harmonic vibrational frequencies    |
| Idx    | indexed                             |
| KS–DFT | Kohn–Sham Density Functional Theory |
| LDA    | Local Density Approximation         |
| MI     | Main Inertial                       |
| ML     | Machine Learning                    |
| Perm   | permuted                            |
| PES    | potential energy surface            |
| RFR    | Random Forest Regression            |
| RMSD   | root–mean–squared–distance          |
| XC     | Exchange and Correlation            |

# 1 Motivation

The harmonic vibrational frequencies (HVF) are valuable quantities due to its important fields of application. They are used for the computation of infrared and Raman spectra, as also for the prediction of thermodynamic quantities. Furthermore, they are necessary for the transition state search. The computation of HVF is costly due to the need of the Hessian matrix, which is a matrix of second derivatives. The acceleration of the computation is therefore of great interest.<sup>[1]</sup>

In general, the computation is done on a multi-level approach, as the computation of single-point energies or optimized geometries is cheap compared to frequency calculations. As the HVF calculation is costly, the used methods need to be cheap. There are different approaches in literature for either accelerating the computation or to increase the precision of Hessian matrices.

Spicher and Grimme developed an approach to force the geometries of low-level methods into the geometries of higher-level methods. A bias depending on the root-mean-squared-distance (RMSD) is added to the potential energy surface (PES) of the low-level method, thus the energy is minimized at the geometry of the high-level method. On this new PES the Hessian matrix is computed, as the HO-approximation is applicable and, the geometry is optimized. The contributions of the bias energy is then detached from the Eigenvalues.<sup>[1]</sup>

Sanders et al. proposed another approach, which is based on the assumption, that the Hessian matrix is a sparse matrix. They use a matrix, that describes the sparse matrix in an incoherent basis. The sparse matrix is approximated by using the matrix in the incoherent basis partially. Hence, instead of computing the full matrix only a part of it needs to be computed. This can be either used to accelerate the computation or to increase the precision by using high-level methods.<sup>[2]</sup>

In the last decades, the amount of information in chemistry is increasing rapidly. This is beneficial regarding, for example, semi-empirical methods, as those depend on empirical derived data. But also in chemistry the interest in new tools like machine learning have risen. Furthermore, due to the increase of information it is of interest, to emphasize the data-supported approach. Therefore, in this research an approach was chosen, to predict the Hessian matrix by ML models to accelerate its computation. It was chosen to use supervised ML. The features of the models are computed from atomic-based quantities.

## 2 Theory

Four topics will be discussed in the Theory as this research relies on those. Supervised Machine Learning models rely on the two quantities feature and target. Features are information given to the model, which then predicts the target value. To train the model features and targets are computed via GFN2-xTB method. To achieve a deliberate system a transformation of coordinates is necessary, for which the Euler angles are used. As already introduced the Hessian matrix is the target. In the last part of this chapter, the two ML algorithms used in this research will be discussed.

### 2.1 Euler Angles

One method of describing coordinate system (CS) transformations, are the Euler angles. They serve as a mathematical tool to connect one CS with another and will be explained in the following with an example.

The initial coordinate system  $x, y, z$ , shown in Fig. 2.1 can be transformed into the  $x', y', z'$  CS by three rotations. The distance between the vectors  $L_a$  and  $L_b$  is shown in red, and is the intersection  $L$  between the  $xy$  and  $x'y'$  planes. The three Euler angles  $\alpha$ ,  $\beta$  and  $\gamma$  are defined as follows. Here,  $\alpha$  is the angle between  $x$  and  $L_a$  and  $\beta$  is the angle between the two  $z$ -axes  $z$  and  $z'$ . The angle  $\gamma$  is the angle between  $L_a$  and  $x'$ .

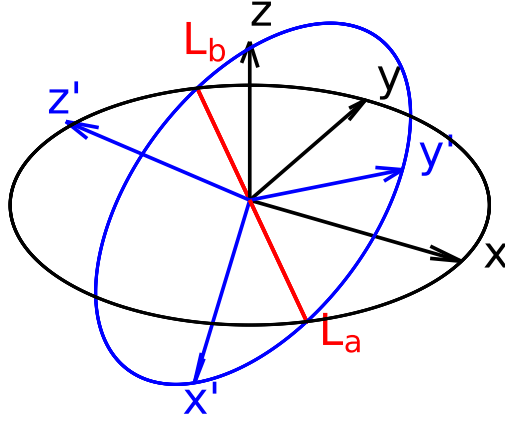


Figure 2.1: Depiction of two coordinate systems  $x, y, z$  (black) and  $x', y', z'$  (blue). The red intersection of the  $xy$  and  $x'y'$  planes is between the vector  $\mathbf{L}_a$  and  $\mathbf{L}_b$ .

For the rotation of the CS it is necessary to apply the rotation matrices in a specific order. The first rotation is around  $z$  by the angle  $\alpha$ , followed by the rotation  $x$  by  $\beta$ . Then a rotation around the  $z$  axis is done by the angle  $\gamma$ . The rotation matrices  $\mathbf{R}_z(\theta)$ , and  $\mathbf{R}_x(\theta)$  are mathematically described in Eq. (2.1.1) and Eq. (2.1.2), respectively. These are the rotation matrices for the Givens-rotation around the  $z$  and  $x$  axes.

$$\mathbf{R}_z(\theta) = \begin{pmatrix} \cos(\theta) & -\sin(\theta) & 0 \\ \sin(\theta) & \cos(\theta) & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \quad (2.1.1)$$

$$\mathbf{R}_x(\theta) = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & \cos(\theta) & -\sin(\theta) \\ 0 & \sin(\theta) & \cos(\theta) \end{pmatrix} \quad (2.1.2)$$

The full rotation of the coordinate system in dependency of the Euler angles is shown in Eq. (2.1.3).

$$\mathbf{R} = \mathbf{R}_z(\gamma) \times \mathbf{R}_x(\beta) \times \mathbf{R}_z(\alpha) \quad (2.1.3)$$

## 2.2 Electronic Structure Theory

In this report, properties derived from electronic structure theory are used for the training of the ML models. As GFN2-xTB is used for this purpose, a short introduction to the Hartree-Fock model and Density Functional Theory is given. The introduction starts from the non-relativistic, stationary electronic Schrödinger-equation. From this the Hartree-Fock model will be derived. This is followed by Density Functional Theory, as this builds the theoretical basis of GFN2-xTB. After that the tight-binding method will be introduced from which the semiempirical method GFN2-xTB is derived. Atomic units are used for all equations in this section. This introduction of Hartree Fock and Density Functional Theory is based on the following reference.<sup>[3]</sup>

### 2.2.1 Hartree-Fock Model

Molecular systems in quantum mechanics can be described by a many-body wave function eigenvalue problem. The solution of this problem is given by solving the Schrödinger equation. The separation of its time-dependency, neglecting relativistic effects and the introduction of the Born-Oppenheimer (BO) approximation results in the electronic Schrödinger equation (Eq. (2.2.1)).

$$\hat{H}_e \Psi_e = E_e \Psi_e \quad (2.2.1)$$

The solution of this eigenvalue equation leads to the electronic energy  $E_e$ . The electronic many-body-wave function  $\Psi_e$  of the system can be described by the Slater determinant (Eq. (2.2.2)). The Pauli principle introduces the condition of the antisymmetry of the wave function. This condition is fulfilled by the Slater determinant. The Slater determinant consists of  $k$  spin-orbital wave functions  $\phi_i$ , and every wave function is permuted with the coordinates  $\mathbf{r}_i$  of the  $N$  electrons. Furthermore, the wave function is normalized by the factor  $(N!)^{-\frac{1}{2}}$ .

$$\Psi_e = \frac{1}{\sqrt{N!}} \begin{vmatrix} \phi_1(\mathbf{r}_1) & \phi_2(\mathbf{r}_1) & \dots & \phi_k(\mathbf{r}_1) \\ \phi_1(\mathbf{r}_2) & \phi_2(\mathbf{r}_2) & & \vdots \\ \vdots & & \ddots & \vdots \\ \phi_1(\mathbf{r}_N) & \dots & \dots & \phi_k(\mathbf{r}_N) \end{vmatrix} \quad (2.2.2)$$

The electronic Hamiltonian  $\hat{H}_e$  in the Hartree-Fock model is shown in Eq. (2.2.3) and consists of the kinetic energy of the electrons and the potential energy between electrons and nuclei as also between the electrons. Furthermore, the nuclear repulsion energy, which is approximated as a constant, is added. The kinetic energy of the nuclei is separated, due to the BO-approximation.

$$\hat{H}_e = \sum_{A=1}^M \sum_{i=1}^N \left( -\frac{1}{2} \nabla_i^2 - \frac{1}{|\mathbf{R}_A - \mathbf{r}_i|} \right) + \sum_{i=1}^N \sum_{\substack{j=1 \\ i>j}}^N \frac{1}{|\mathbf{r}_i - \mathbf{r}_j|} + \sum_{A=1}^M \sum_{\substack{B=1 \\ B>A}}^M \frac{Z_A Z_B}{|\mathbf{R}_A - \mathbf{R}_B|} \quad (2.2.3)$$

Here,  $\mathbf{R}_A$  are the coordinates of atom  $A$ ,  $\mathbf{r}_i$  the coordinates of electron  $i$  and  $Z_A$  the nuclear charge. While,  $\nabla_i^2$  is the second derivative in respect to every coordinate of electron  $i$ .

The electronic energy can now be described with the Slater determinant and Hamiltonian in Eq. (2.2.4). This leads to the description of the energy by the one-electron operator  $\hat{h}_i$ , the coulomb operator  $\hat{J}_i$  and the exchange operator  $\hat{K}_i$ .

$$E_e = \sum_{i=1}^N \langle \phi_i | \hat{h}_i | \phi_i \rangle + \frac{1}{2} \sum_{i=1}^N \sum_{j=1}^N \left( \langle \phi_j | \hat{J}_i | \phi_j \rangle - \langle \phi_j | \hat{K}_i | \phi_j \rangle \right) \quad (2.2.4)$$

The Rayleigh–Ritz variational principle (s. Eq. (2.2.5)) states, that the total energy  $E_0$  of the system is always beneath or equal to the energy corresponding to the approximated wave function. This allows the search of the exact energy by optimizing the wave function (or its parameters).

$$E_0 \leq \langle \Psi | \hat{H} | \Psi \rangle \quad (2.2.5)$$

The determination of the total energy of the system is an eigenvalue problem and can be solved by minimization. To minimize the energy, Lagrangian optimization is employed, under the condition of orthonormal  $\phi_i$ . Hence, the inner product of the wave function  $\langle \phi_i | \phi_j \rangle = \delta_{ij}$  corresponds to the Kronecker delta (Eq. (2.2.6)).

$$\langle \phi_i | \phi_j \rangle = \delta_{ij} = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } i \neq j \\ 1 & \text{if } i = j \end{cases} \quad (2.2.6)$$

The derivative of the Lagrangian functional leads to the canonical Fock equation (2.2.7), which is a solution for the minimal energy.

$$\hat{f}(\mathbf{r}_i) \phi_k(\mathbf{r}_i) = \epsilon(\mathbf{r}_i) \phi_k(\mathbf{r}_i) \quad (2.2.7)$$

$$\hat{f}(\mathbf{r}_i) = \hat{h} + \sum_{j=1}^N (2\hat{J}_j - \hat{K}_j) \quad (2.2.8)$$

The Fock–operator  $\hat{f}(\mathbf{r}_i)$  is an effective one-electron operator. This enables the determination of the spin-orbital wave functions in an iterative manner, as the Fock-operator itself depends on the spin-orbital wave functions. The iterative search is possible due to the self-consistency of the Hartree–Fock equation. Furthermore, the general optimization can be achieved due to the Rayleigh–Ritz variational principle. Important to point out is that the Fock-operator consists of the one-electron operator, the exchange-operator and the coulomb operator, while the correlation is not included.

The spin-orbital wave functions are described via a basis set approximation. This LCAO-approach is shown in Eq. (2.2.9), where the spin-orbital wave-functions are the sum of  $K$  basis functions with an

associated constant.

$$\phi_i(\mathbf{r}) = \sum_{\mu}^K c_{\mu} \chi_{\mu}(\mathbf{r}) \quad (2.2.9)$$

Merging the basis-set approach into Eq. (2.2.7) leads to the Roothaan–Hall equation shown in Eq. (2.2.15). Here,  $\mathbf{F}$  is the Fock matrix,  $\mathbf{C}$  a matrix of coefficients  $c_{\mu}$ ,  $\mathbf{S}$  the overlap matrix and  $\epsilon$  the diagonal eigenvalue matrix. This equation is used to find a solution for the energy iteratively. Starting with an initial guess of the Fock matrix, the matrix  $\mathbf{C}$  is computed, with this matrix, the density matrix  $\mathbf{D}$  is calculated. The density matrix  $\mathbf{D}$ , is then used for the calculation of the new Fock matrix.

$$\mathbf{FC} = \mathbf{SC}\epsilon \quad (2.2.10)$$

## 2.2.2 Kohn–Sham Density Functional Theory

As mentioned above, the correlation between electrons is not described in the Hartree–Fock model, due to the use of a single Slater determinant.

The correlation energy can be described by two different approaches. Instead of using one single Slater determinant, a linear combination of Slater determinants can be used. This leads to the post–Hartree–Fock methods like Full–CI or MP2. The second approach is the Density Functional Theory (DFT).

The Hohenberg–Kohn theorems build the basis for the DFT. These two theorems postulate, that the energy is a functional of the density, and that this functional follows the variational principle.

The description of the energy can therefore be done via the density of the electrons, which is defined in Eq. (2.2.11). Where,  $n_{\text{occ}}$  is the occupation number of the spin–orbital wave function.

$$\rho(\mathbf{r}) = n_{\text{occ}} \sum_{i=1}^n |\phi_i(\mathbf{r})|^2 \quad (2.2.11)$$

The general approach is to describe the energy in dependence of the electron density  $E[\rho]$ . There are different approaches for this connection. The most known approach, Kohn–Sham Density Functional Theory (KS–DFT), will be discussed. The energy in KS–DFT consists of the inexact kinetic energy, coulomb integral, the exchange correlation energy and the potential field. The kinetic energy is inexact, due to the assumption of non–interacting electrons. The energy  $E_{\text{XC}}$  consists mainly of the correlation energy and the exchange energy. In theory, the energy  $E_{\text{XC}}$  should also include the self interaction energy and a correction to the kinetic energy.

$$E[\{\phi_i\}] = T[\{\phi_i\}] + J[\rho] + E_{\text{XC}}[\rho] + \int v(\mathbf{r})\rho(\mathbf{r})d\mathbf{r} \quad (2.2.12)$$

The minimization of the energy is done by a Lagrangian optimization with analogue conditions compared to Hartree–Fock. This leads to the Kohn–Sham operator and a new eigenequation, which is shown in Eq (2.2.13).

$$\hat{f}^{\text{KS}}(\mathbf{r}_i)\phi_k(\mathbf{r}_i) = \epsilon(\mathbf{r}_i)\phi_k(\mathbf{r}_i) \quad (2.2.13)$$

$$\hat{f}^{\text{KS}}(\mathbf{r}_i) = \hat{h}_i + 2 \sum_{j=1}^n \hat{J}_j + \hat{v}_{\text{xc}} \quad (2.2.14)$$

In comparison to the Fock operator,  $\hat{f}^{\text{KS}}(\mathbf{r}_i)$  includes an exchange–correlation term, instead of the exchange operator. With a basis set approach analogue to the HF model, an eigenvalue equation similar to the Roothaan–Hall equation is derived.

$$\mathbf{FC} = \mathbf{SC}\epsilon \quad (2.2.15)$$

### 2.2.3 GFN2–xTB Electronic Structure Method

GFN2–xTB is a Density Functional Tight Binding (DFTB) method, that is optimized for **G**eometries, **F**requencies and **N**oncovalent interaction energies. In these DFTB methods, the electron density  $\rho_0$  is a linear combination of atomic electron densities  $\rho_{0,A}$ .

$$\rho_0 = \sum_A \rho_{0,A} \quad (2.2.16)$$

The energy is expanded by a Taylor series around the electron density  $\rho_0$ . The bonding is then described as a perturbation of this density. In GFN2–xTB the expansion is done up to the third order.

$$E[\rho] = E^{(0)}[\rho_0] + E^{(1)}[\rho_0, (\delta\rho)] + E^{(2)}[\rho_0, (\delta\rho)^2] + E^{(3)}[\rho_0, (\delta\rho)^3] + \dots \quad (2.2.17)$$

Furthermore, the energy is described with the kinetic energy  $T[\rho(\mathbf{r})]$  and the external potential, due to the nuclei  $V_n(\mathbf{r})$ . A local density approximation (LDA) is used for the description of the exchange–correlation energy  $\epsilon_{\text{xc}}^{\text{LDA}}$ . As the LDA neglects the long range correlation effects, these are described via a non–local correlation contribution  $\Phi_{\text{C}}^{\text{NL}}(\mathbf{r}, \mathbf{r}')$ . This is in contrast to other DFTB methods like DTFB3.

$$E[\rho] = \int \rho(\mathbf{r}) \left[ T[\rho(\mathbf{r})] + V_n(\mathbf{r}) + \epsilon_{\text{xc}}^{\text{LDA}}[\rho(\mathbf{r})] + \frac{1}{2} \int \left( \frac{1}{|\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{r}'|} + \Phi_{\text{C}}^{\text{NL}}(\mathbf{r}, \mathbf{r}') \right) \rho(\mathbf{r}') d\mathbf{r}' \right] d\mathbf{r} + E_{nn} \quad (2.2.18)$$

The terms of Eq. (2.2.17) can be divided into different energy contributions. These contributions will be briefly discussed. The zeroth order term shown in Eq. (2.2.19) consists of the repulsion energy  $E_{\text{rep}}^{(0)}$  and dispersion energy  $E_{\text{disp}}^{(0)}$ . These are typically described by Buckingham or Lennard–

Jones potentials. In GFN2-xTB a classical parametrized repulsion energy is used, which depends on the distance between to atoms. The dispersion term arises, due to the non-local correlation functional. Furthermore, the zeroth order term energy of the valence electrons  $E_{A,\text{valence}}^{(0)}$  and core electron  $E_{A,\text{core}}^{(0)}$  is summed, though the energy of the core electrons is defined as zero.

$$E[\rho_0] \approx E_{\text{rep}}^{(0)} + E_{\text{disp}}^{(0)} + \sum_A \left( E_{A,\text{valence}}^{(0)} + E_{A,\text{core}}^{(0)} \right) \quad (2.2.19)$$

The first order perturbation energy  $E^{(1)}[\rho_0, (\delta\rho)]$  is approximately described by a first order dispersion energy  $E_{\text{disp}}^{(1)}$ , and first order valence electron energy  $E_{A,\text{valence}}^{(1)}$ . This perturbation allows the description of covalent bonding, as the electron density so far is described as spherical densities around the atoms, with no interaction.

$$E^{(1)}[\rho_0, (\delta\rho)] \approx E_{\text{disp}}^{(1)} + \sum_A E_{A,\text{valence}}^{(1)} \quad (2.2.20)$$

The second order energy perturbation  $E^{(2)}[\rho_0, (\delta\rho)^2]$  is described by the contribution of dispersion, electrostatics and exchange correlation energies. The exchange and correlation energy  $E_{\text{XC}}^{(2)}$  and electrostatic energy  $E_{\text{ES}}^{(2)}$  are described in GFN2-xTB with an isotropic and anisotropic contribution. This is in contrast to other DFTB methods, where only a monopole approximation is done. Hence, there is only an isotropic description in other methods.

$$E^{(2)}[\rho_0, (\delta\rho)^2] \approx E_{\text{ES}}^{(2)} + E_{\text{XC}}^{(2)} + E_{\text{disp}}^{(2)} \quad (2.2.21)$$

For the third order perturbation, only the electrostatic and exchange correlation energies are used and computed with the Mulliken approximation. All other contributions to the third order perturbation are neglected.

$$E^{(3)}[\rho_0, (\delta\rho)^3] \approx E_{\text{ES}}^{(3)} + E_{\text{XC}}^{(3)} \quad (2.2.22)$$

Merging all energy contributions shown in Eq. (2.2.19) to Eq. (2.2.22) into Eq. (2.2.17) leads to Eq. (2.2.23). Though, some further adjustments are done. The isotropic contribution of the electrostatic and exchange correlation energies are described by a single term  $E_{\text{IES+IEC}}$ . While the anisotropic electrostatic energy  $E_{\text{AES}}$  and anisotropic exchange correlation energy  $E_{\text{AXC}}$  are described separately. The valence electron energy contributions are described via the extended Hückel type energy  $E_{\text{EHT}}$ . Independent of the above discussed perturbation, an energy term  $G_{\text{Fermi}}$  describing the Fermi-smearing is included, which leads to the complete energy equation shown in Eq. (2.2.23).

$$E_{\text{GFN2-xTB}} = E_{\text{rep}} + E_{\text{EHT}} + E_{\text{disp}} + E_{\text{IES+IEC}} + E_{\text{AES}} + E_{\text{AXC}} + G_{\text{Fermi}} \quad (2.2.23)$$

The wave function is approximated by a minimal valence basis set STO-*m*G. The energy is computed similar to KS-DFT and Hartree Fock. The Roothaan-Hall type Eq. (2.2.15) is solved in a selfconsistent manner.

## 2.3 Hessian Matrices

The Hessian matrices are the target for the ML model. The Hessian is of interest, due to its need for the computation of harmonic vibrational frequencies of molecules and thermodynamic quantities. The harmonic vibrational frequencies can be used for the computation of wave numbers, with which IR spectra can be constructed. Furthermore, they can be used for the transition state search, as imaginary harmonic vibrational frequencies indicate a transition state. Therefore, a brief introduction to the Hessian elements and its projection and mass weighting is given.

The Hessian matrix is a  $3M \times 3M$  matrix ( $M$  is the number of atoms) of second derivatives of the energy in respect to every atom coordinate pair in the system.

$$\mathbf{H} = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial x_A \partial x_A} & \cdots & \frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial x_A \partial y_M} & \frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial x_A \partial z_M} \\ \frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial x_A \partial y_A} & \ddots & & \vdots \\ \vdots & & \ddots & \vdots \\ \frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial z_N \partial x_A} & \cdots & & \frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial z_M \partial z_M} \end{pmatrix} \quad (2.3.1)$$

$\mathbf{H}$  can also be described by  $M^2$   $3 \times 3$  block matrices, where each  $3 \times 3$  matrix depends on the coordinates of an atom pair. Theses  $3 \times 3$  block matrices are beneficial for the prediction, as they only depend on two atoms. Hence, only information about the two atoms need to be given to the machine learning model to predict the block matrix.

$$\mathbf{H} = \begin{pmatrix} \mathbf{H}_{AA} & \mathbf{H}_{AB} & \cdots & \mathbf{H}_{AM} \\ \mathbf{H}_{BA} & \ddots & & \vdots \\ \vdots & & \ddots & \vdots \\ \mathbf{H}_{MA} & \cdots & \cdots & \mathbf{H}_{MM} \end{pmatrix} \quad (2.3.2)$$

Due to the Schwartz Theorem, the  $\mathbf{H}_{BA}$  and  $\mathbf{H}_{AB}$  are related to another by Eq. (2.3.3)

$$\mathbf{H}_{BA} = (\mathbf{H}_{AB})^T \quad (2.3.3)$$

Therefore, the information of the Hessian can be stored as a triangular matrix (s. Eq. (2.3.4)).

$$\mathbf{H} = \begin{pmatrix} \mathbf{H}_{AA} & \mathbf{H}_{AB} & \dots & \mathbf{H}_{AM} \\ & \ddots & & \vdots \\ & 0 & \ddots & \vdots \\ & & & \mathbf{H}_{MM} \end{pmatrix} \quad (2.3.4)$$

The Hessian matrix needs to be projected for the computation harmonic frequencies. For the projection the rotational and translational parts of the Hessian need to be detected. A  $6 \times 3N$  matrix is constructed, that describes the rotation and translation of each atom. For an atom  $A$ , the overlap is depicted in Eq. (2.3.5). The translation correspond to the first 3 rows of the matrix  $\mathbf{O}_A$ . While the contribution of the rotation is given in the lower 3 rows. For example, the rotation around the x-axis leads to the translation of the y-coordinate  $\mathbf{r}_A^y$  by  $\mathbf{r}_A^z$ . While the z-coordinate is moved by  $-\mathbf{r}_A^y$ .

$$\mathbf{O}_A = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & \mathbf{r}_A^z & -\mathbf{r}_A^y \\ -\mathbf{r}_A^z & 0 & \mathbf{r}_A^x \\ \mathbf{r}_A^y & -\mathbf{r}_A^x & 0 \end{pmatrix} \quad (2.3.5)$$

For a system of  $N$  atoms, the full matrix  $\mathbf{O}$  is shown in Eq. (2.3.6)

$$\mathbf{O} = \begin{pmatrix} \mathbf{O}_A & \mathbf{O}_B & \dots & \mathbf{O}_N \end{pmatrix} \quad (2.3.6)$$

After that, the rotation and translation matrix is normalized to  $\mathbf{O}_n$  by the 1-norm. For the detection, the overlap matrix  $\mathbf{M}$  between the normalized rotation and translation matrix and the Hessian matrix is computed (s. Eq. (2.3.7)). The multiplication of the  $6 \times 3M$  and  $3M \times 3M$  matrix leads to a  $6 \times 3M$  matrix.

$$\mathbf{M} = \mathbf{O}_n \times \mathbf{H} \quad (2.3.7)$$

The columns of  $\mathbf{M}$  are summed up, which leads to a  $3N$  vector. The maximum values of this vector corresponds to the highest overlap between a row in the Hessian matrix and the translations and rotation matrix. The six highest values are searched, and the numbers of the corresponding rows are stored in a vector  $\mathbf{v}$ .

For a linear molecule only the five highest values are searched. The differentiation between linear and non-linear molecules is done by the norm of the coordinates  $\|\mathbf{r}^x\|$ ,  $\|\mathbf{r}^y\|$  and  $\|\mathbf{r}^z\|$ . If the sum of the norm of two coordinates is below a threshold of  $\|\mathbf{r}^{x,y,z}\| < 1 \cdot 10^{-6}$  a linear molecule is assumed.

For the projection itself, the eigenvectors  $\mathbf{Q}$  of the Hessian matrix and its eigenvalues  $\lambda$  are required.

$$\mathbf{H}^{\text{proj}} = \mathbf{H} - \sum_{i \in \mathbf{v}} \lambda_i \cdot \mathbf{Q}^T_i \otimes (\mathbf{Q}^T_i)^T \quad (2.3.8)$$

At last, the Hessian needs to be mass weighted.

$$\mathbf{H}_{AB}^{\text{proj},w} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{m_A m_B}} \mathbf{H}_{AB}^{\text{proj}} \quad (2.3.9)$$

Eq. (2.3.9) is applied to every Hessian matrix block  $\mathbf{H}_{AB}$  in the full Hessian matrix  $\mathbf{H}$ , which leads to the projected mass weighted Hessian matrix  $\mathbf{H}^{\text{proj},w}$ .

## 2.4 Machine Learning

This section deals with basics of the ML algorithms and is based on the following reference.<sup>[4]</sup> Extra Tree Regression (ETR) and Random Forest Regression (RFR) are used as ML algorithms in this research. Both algorithms are ensemble methods based on decision trees as individual estimators. In this section, decision tree based algorithms will be discussed, and the differences between the ETR and RFR will be emphasized.

Often these decision tree based algorithms are based on the Classification and Regression Tree (CART) algorithm. The CART algorithm will be explained with an example. Assuming a response  $Y$  that depends on two variables  $X_1$  and  $X_2$  is assumed. The variables  $X_1$  and  $X_2$  are called features. A tree based model splits the space of this function into several recursive binary partitions. Recursive binary means in this case, that the splits are orthogonal to the axis of the features. This split is shown on the left in Fig. 2.2.

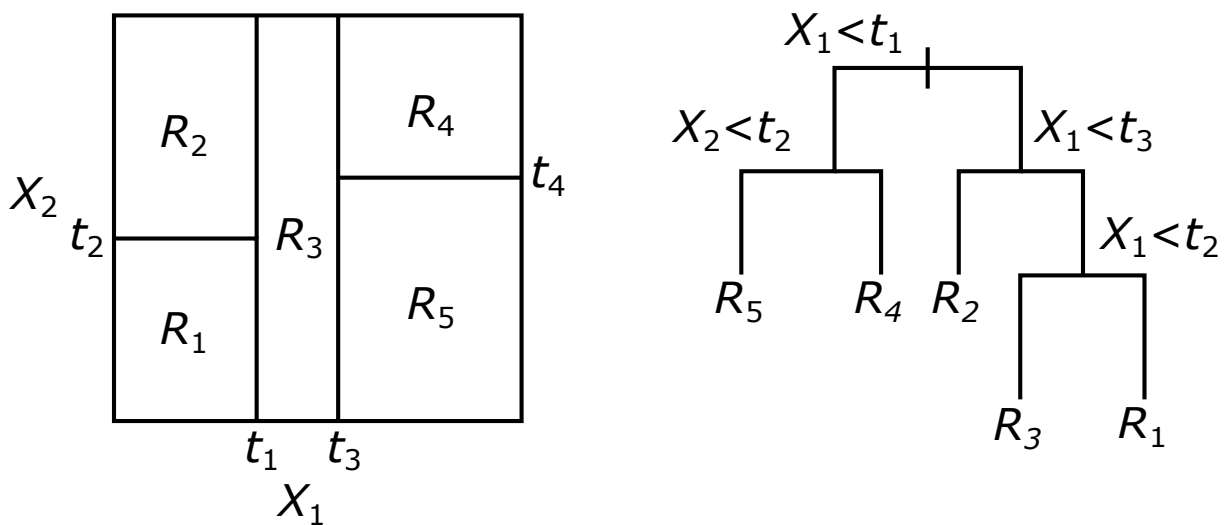


Figure 2.2: The recursively binary grown split is shown on the left. On the right, the resulting Decision Tree is depicted.

In each partition  $Y$  is modeled with a function or constant  $R_i$ . This can also be depicted in a more familiar approach, which is the decision tree. This is shown in Fig. 2.2. Both depictions lead to the same result.

The splitting points  $t_1$  to  $t_4$  are chosen differently for the RFR and ETR. In RFR, the splitting point is determined by choosing the best feature and of this feature the best split value. Hence, it is a two dimensional search. In the case of the ETR, the feature is chosen randomly. After that, the best split value for this feature is chosen. The relation between the features and the partitioned response  $Y$  can be depicted in a decision tree, which is shown in Fig. 2.2 on the right. This can also be described mathematically via Eq. (2.4.1)

$$\hat{f}(X) = \sum_{m=1}^5 c_m I\{(X_1, X_2) \in R_m\} \quad (2.4.1)$$

Here,  $\hat{f}(X)$  is the function that describes the response  $Y$ . Each region  $m$  has a corresponding constant  $c_m$ . The function  $I$  can either be  $I = 1$ , if the features  $X_1$  and  $X_2$  are in the rectangle  $R_m$ , or it is  $I = 0$ , if it is not the case. Originally, the ETR and RFR have another difference, which is that the ETR did not use bootstrapping.<sup>[5]</sup> Bootstrapping uses the training set and makes several new training sets from this. The new training sets are randomly filled with the datasets of the original training set. This differentiation is not necessarily done anymore. In software like `sklearn`<sup>[6]</sup> it is choosable to use bootstrapping or not.

## 3 Methods

### 3.1 Transformation of Coordinates

The Hessian matrix and some features depend on the orientation of the coordinate system (CS). For the ML model a consistent orientation for every atom pair is necessary. Furthermore, the Hessian elements shall be learned atom pair wise. Thus, the orientation of the molecule is brought into atom pair focused CS, where the origin of the CS is in the center of the considered atom pair, while both atoms are on the z-Axis. In this section, the transformation of the initial coordinate system into the atom pair focused CS will be discussed.

The CS of the molecule is deliberate, therefore a transformation to a welldefined reference coordinate system is necessary. As a reference coordinate system is main inertia coordinate system (MI CS) is chosen. In a second step the transformation to the atom pair focused coordinate system (APF CS) is performed.

At first a translation of the origin of the initial CS to the center of mass is done by Eq. (3.1.1).

$$\mathbf{r}_A^s = \mathbf{r}_A^{\text{init}} - \mathbf{s}^{\text{init}} \quad (3.1.1)$$

Where  $\mathbf{r}_A^s$  is the coordinate vector of an atom  $A$  in the mass centered CS,  $\mathbf{r}_A^{\text{init}}$  the coordinate vector in the initial CS and  $\mathbf{s}^{\text{init}}$  is the center of mass in the initial CS, and is defined in Eq. (3.1.2).

$$\mathbf{s}^{\text{init}} = \frac{1}{m_{\text{tot}}} \sum_A^M m_A \cdot \mathbf{r}_A^{\text{init}} \quad (3.1.2)$$

Here  $m_A$  is the mass of atom  $A$ ,  $m_{\text{tot}}$  is the mass of the molecule and  $M$  the number of atoms in the molecule. Once the origin of the new CS is determined, the orientation of its axes is arranged to the moment of inertia as computed by Eq. (3.1.3).

$$\mathbf{I}^s = \begin{pmatrix} I_{xx} & I_{xy} & I_{xz} \\ I_{yx} & I_{yy} & I_{yz} \\ I_{zx} & I_{zy} & I_{zz} \end{pmatrix}; I_{ab} = \begin{cases} \sum_A^M m_A (b_A^2 + c_A^2) & \text{if } a = b \\ -\sum_A^M m_A \cdot a_A \cdot b_A & \text{if } a \neq b \end{cases} \quad a, b \in x, y, z \quad (3.1.3)$$

For the computation of the elements  $I_{ab}$  of the inertia tensor  $I^s$  the diagonal elements and non-diagonal elements are divided in two cases. Here,  $a$  and  $b$  are variables for the spatial directions of the coordinates  $x, y$  and  $z$ . For the rotation of the mass centered origin CS into the main inertia system, the matrix  $\mathbf{R}_{mi}^{init}$  of eigenvectors of the inertia tensor  $I^s$  is needed. For that, the eigenvectors  $\mathbf{R}_{mi}^{init}$  are computed by solving the eigenvalue equation. The eigenvalues are then used to get the eigenvectors. To assure, that the matrix  $\mathbf{R}_{mi}^{init}$  is a right-handed matrix the determinant is calculated. If the determinant is negative, the sign of the third eigenvector is changed. Furthermore, it needs to be assured, that the eigenvector matrix is consistently rotated in the same direction, independent of the outgoing position. The chosen constraint is, that the highest value of the eigenvectors are positive, if this is not the case the sign of the eigenvector and the next eigenvector in  $\mathbf{R}_{mi}^{init}$  is changed. The rotation of the coordinates is done by Eq. (3.1.4).

$$\mathbf{r}_A^{mi} = \mathbf{R}_{mi}^{init} \mathbf{r}_A^s \quad (3.1.4)$$

Here,  $\mathbf{r}_A^{mi}$  is the coordinate of an atom  $A$  in the main inertia CS. The rotation is done for every atom in the molecule. After that operation, the molecule is in the main inertia CS.

The Hessian matrix also depends on the CS and therefore needs to be rotated, too. A translation is not needed. Eq. (3.1.6) describes the rotation of the Hessian matrix in the initial CS to the main inertia system. For this a  $3M \times 3M$  rotation matrix  $\mathbf{P}_{mi}^{init}$  needs to be constructed, where the diagonal  $3 \times 3$  blocks are  $\mathbf{R}_{mi}^{init}$ . This matrix is shown in Eq. (3.1.5).

$$\mathbf{P}_{mi}^{init} = \begin{pmatrix} \mathbf{R}_{mi}^{init} & \mathbf{0} & \mathbf{0} \\ \mathbf{0} & \mathbf{R}_{mi}^{init} & \mathbf{0} \\ \mathbf{0} & \mathbf{0} & \mathbf{0} \\ \mathbf{0} & \mathbf{0} & \mathbf{0} \end{pmatrix} \quad (3.1.5)$$

$$\mathbf{H}^{mi} = \mathbf{P}_{mi}^{init} \times \mathbf{H}^{init} \times (\mathbf{P}_{mi}^{init})^T \quad (3.1.6)$$

The Hessian matrix in the initial system is  $\mathbf{H}^{init}$ , while the Hessian matrix in the main inertia system is  $\mathbf{H}^{mi}$ .

In the following, the transformation of the main inertia CS to the atom pair focused CS will be discussed. The transformation starts with the translation of the origin to the center of an atom pair. The translation is described with Eq. (3.1.7).

$$\mathbf{r}_C^{\text{mi},c} = \mathbf{r}_C^{\text{mi}} - \left( \frac{1}{2}\mathbf{r}_A^{\text{mi}} + \frac{1}{2}\mathbf{r}_B^{\text{mi}} \right) \text{ for } C \in A, B, \dots, N \quad (3.1.7)$$

After this operation, the origin of the CS is in the center of the atom pair. To fix the orientation, the atom pair is aligned along the  $z$ -axis. The Euler angles are used to determine the rotation matrix. The rotation of the CS depends on the considered atom pair. It is divided into whether  $A = B$  or  $A \neq B$ . At first the construction of the rotation matrix for the case  $A \neq B$  will be discussed.

The  $z$ -axis of the atom pair focused CS is aligned to  $\mathbf{r}_A^{\text{mi},c}$ . The  $x$ -axis is defined in Eq. (3.1.8), where  $\mathbf{z}$  is a unit vector in  $z$ -direction of the atom pair focused CS, and  $\boldsymbol{\mu}_A$  is the dipole moment of the atom  $A$ .

$$\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{z} \times (\boldsymbol{\mu}_A + \boldsymbol{\mu}_B) \quad (3.1.8)$$

The intersection  $\mathbf{L}$  of the  $xy$ -plane of the atom pair focused CS and  $xy$ -plane of the centered main inertia CS is described with Eq. (3.1.9).

$$\mathbf{L} = \mathbf{x} \times \mathbf{z}^{\text{mi},c} \quad (3.1.9)$$

The intersection  $\mathbf{L}$ , the axes  $\mathbf{x}$ ,  $\mathbf{z}$ ,  $\mathbf{x}^{\text{mi},c}$  and  $\mathbf{z}^{\text{mi},c}$  are then used for the computation of the Euler angles  $\alpha$ ,  $\beta$  and  $\gamma$  via Eq. (3.1.10).

$$\alpha^0 = \arccos \left( \frac{\mathbf{L} \cdot \mathbf{x}^{\text{mi},c}}{|\mathbf{L}| \cdot |\mathbf{x}^{\text{mi},c}|} \right) \quad (3.1.10a)$$

$$\beta = \arccos \left( \frac{\mathbf{x} \cdot \mathbf{z}^{\text{mi},c}}{|\mathbf{x}| \cdot |\mathbf{z}^{\text{mi},c}|} \right) \quad (3.1.10b)$$

$$\gamma^0 = \arccos \left( \frac{\mathbf{L} \cdot \mathbf{x}}{|\mathbf{L}| \cdot |\mathbf{x}|} \right) \quad (3.1.10c)$$

For the right rotation, it has to be considered, whether the vectors  $\mathbf{x}^{\text{mi},c}$ ,  $\mathbf{z}^{\text{mi},c}$  and  $\mathbf{L}$  span a right-handed coordinate system or left-handed. This is done by constructing a matrix of these vectors and computing the determinant. The determinant can be used, as it is equal to the triple product for a  $3 \times 3$  matrix.

$$\mathbf{A} = (\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{z}, \mathbf{L}) \quad (3.1.11)$$

$$\mathbf{G} = (\mathbf{L}, \mathbf{x}^{\text{mi},c}, \mathbf{z}^{\text{mi},c}) \quad (3.1.12)$$

$$\alpha = \begin{cases} \alpha^0 & \text{if } \det(\mathbf{A}) = 1 \\ 2\pi - \alpha^0 & \text{if } \det(\mathbf{A}) = -1 \end{cases} \quad (3.1.13)$$

$$\gamma = \begin{cases} \gamma^0 & \text{if } \det(\mathbf{G}) = -1 \\ 2\pi - \gamma^0 & \text{if } \det(\mathbf{G}) = 1 \end{cases} \quad (3.1.14)$$

Via these constraints, the Euler angles  $\alpha$  and  $\gamma$  are chosen. The Euler angles are then used to build up the rotation matrices via Eq. (2.1.1) and (2.1.2).

The complete rotation matrix is then constructed by the cross product of the single rotation matrices and is shown in Eq. (3.1.15).

$$\mathbf{R}^0 = \mathbf{R}_z(\gamma) \times \mathbf{R}_x(\beta) \times \mathbf{R}_z(\alpha) \quad (3.1.15)$$

If the x-values of the rotated dipole moment  $\mu$  are negative, the matrix is rotated by  $180^\circ$  around the z-axis. This is depicted in Eq. (3.1.16).

$$\mathbf{R}_{\text{mi}}^{\text{apf}} = \begin{cases} \mathbf{R}^0 & \text{if } \mu^x > 0 \\ \mathbf{R}^0 \times \mathbf{R}_z(\pi) & \text{if } \mu^x < 0 \end{cases} \quad (3.1.16)$$

Lastly, the rotation of the translated coordinate system is done via Eq. (3.1.17).

$$\mathbf{r}_A^{\text{apf}} = \mathbf{R}_{\text{mi}}^{\text{apf}} \times \mathbf{r}_A^{\text{mi,c}} \quad (3.1.17)$$

The coordinates  $\mathbf{r}_A^{\text{apf}}$  are the final coordinates in the APF CS for the case of a heteronuclear atom pair.

For the case of a homonuclear atom pair, the procedure is the same up to the translation of the coordinates into the centered inertial main CS. The z-axes of APF CS and centered inertial main CS are aligned. Therefore, the Euler angle  $\beta$  is zero. Furthermore, the xy-planes are the same, and there is no intersection of the xy-planes. Thus, only one angle  $\alpha$  or  $\gamma$  is necessary for the rotation. Therefore,  $\gamma$  is the angle between the x-axis of the centered main inertial CS and the APF CS. To provide consistency in the rotation of the coordinates, the x-axis is chosen in dependency of the dipole moment  $\mu$  of the considered atom. Eq. (3.1.18) shows how the x-axis is computed.

$$\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{z} \times \mu_A \quad (3.1.18)$$

This results in the computation of the angle  $\gamma^0$  by Eq. (3.1.19).

$$\gamma^0 = \arccos \left( \frac{\mathbf{x}^{\text{mi},c} \cdot \mathbf{x}}{|\mathbf{x}^{\text{mi},c}| \cdot |\mathbf{x}|} \right) \quad (3.1.19)$$

Between two vectors are two angles, which sum up to  $2\pi$ . The rotation of the CS depends on the arrangement to another. The angle is chosen by the following condition, show in Eq. (3.1.20).

$$\gamma = \begin{cases} \gamma^0 & \text{if } x_y < 0 \\ 2\pi - \gamma^0 & \text{if } x_y \geq 0 \end{cases} \quad (3.1.20)$$

The further procedure of the transformation is done in the same way as for the heteronuclear atomic pair. The rotation matrix is computed via Eq. (3.1.15). This followed by an adjustment of the rotation matrix, shown in Eq. (3.1.16). The final rotation matrix  $\mathbf{R}_{\text{mi}}^{\text{apf}}$  is then used on the coordinates  $\mathbf{r}_A^{\text{mi},c}$  via Eq. (3.1.17).

In the APF CS the computation of the Hessian was done. For each APF CS one  $3 \times 3$  Hessian matrix block is of interest. To rebuild the Hessian matrix in the MI CS, each Hessian matrix block needs to undergo a rotation back to the MI CS. For this the all rotation matrices  $\mathbf{R}_{\text{mi}}^{\text{apf}}$  need to be stored. The rotation back into the MI CS is done by Eq. (3.1.21).

$$\mathbf{H}_{\text{AB}}^{\text{mi}} = \left( \mathbf{R}_{\text{mi}}^{\text{apf}} \right)^T \times \mathbf{H}_{\text{AB}}^{\text{apf}} \times \mathbf{R}_{\text{mi}}^{\text{apf}} \quad (3.1.21)$$

In the MI CS, the Hessian matrix  $\mathbf{H}^{\text{mi}}$  is filled with the blocks  $\mathbf{H}_{\text{AB}}^{\text{mi}}$ . Before some quantities for measuring can be computed, the  $\mathbf{H}^{\text{mi}}$  is projected and mass-weighted. Thus, the  $\mathbf{H}^{\text{proj},w|\text{mi}}$  is build. The procedure of the projection and mass-weighting is described in the chapter Theory.

## 3.2 ML Model Construction

The supervised ML models have to be trained with a set of features and targets. The features are in general derived from atom based quantities based on geometry, density and energy. Also they originate mainly from Steinbach's work.<sup>[7]</sup> Some adaptations are done. Here, the cartesian dipole moment and quadrupole moment elements are used as features instead of its norm. This applies also for the extended versions. The Hessian matrix is the target. The atom based quantities and Hessian matrix are generated with the GFN2-xTB method. Furthermore, they are all computed for each Hessian matrix block  $\mathbf{H}_{AB}$  in its own APF CS. Beside atom based quantities, features are implemented for the differentiation between the elements of a block  $\mathbf{H}_{AB}$ . Two approaches are used for the differentiation. These are the **indexed** and **permuted** approach.

Table 3.1: List of quantities used for the ML models as features. The quantities are divided into geometry, density and energy based quantities.

| Feature             | Description                                                           | Extension |
|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Geometry</b>     |                                                                       |           |
| $R_{AB}$            | Distance between two Atoms                                            |           |
| $CN_A$              | Coordination Number                                                   | ✓         |
| <b>Density</b>      |                                                                       |           |
| $\mu_A$             | Dipole Moment                                                         | ✓         |
| $\mu_{A,p}$         | Dipole Moment on A, due to distribution on p and $\mu$ on other atoms |           |
| $\theta_A$          | Quadrupole Moment                                                     | ✓         |
| <b>Energy</b>       |                                                                       |           |
| $E_{A,gap}$         | HOMO – LUMO gap                                                       | ✓         |
| $\mu_{A,pot}$       | Chemical Potential                                                    | ✓         |
| $\epsilon_{A,HOAO}$ | Atomic HOMO                                                           | ✓         |
| $\epsilon_{A,LUAO}$ | Atomic LUMO                                                           | ✓         |
| $E_{A,rep}$         | Repulsion                                                             |           |
| $E_{A,EHT}$         | extended Hückel theory                                                |           |
| $E_{A,disp}^{(2)}$  | Dispersion 2 <sup>nd</sup> order                                      |           |
| $E_{A,disp}^{(3)}$  | Dispersion 3 <sup>rd</sup> order                                      |           |
| $E_{A,IES+IXC}$     | Isotropic ES and XC                                                   |           |
| $E_{A,AES}$         | Anisotropic ES                                                        |           |
| $E_{A,AXC}$         | Anisotropic XC                                                        |           |
| $E_{A,tot}$         | Total Energy                                                          |           |

The quantities computed with GFN2-xTB are listed in Tab. 3.1 with a short description. There is an extended version for some quantities. If this is the case, the column Extension is ticked. The mathematical descriptions of all quantities from GFN2-xTB are shown in the Appendix in Eq. (7.0.1) The features are computed for every Hessian matrix block  $\mathbf{H}_{AB}$ . As these depend only on the atoms  $A$  and  $B$ , the atom based quantities of  $A$  and  $B$  are used for the computation of the features. Two different models are used for the case of  $A = B$  and  $A \neq B$ , due to two reasons. At first the chosen orientation in the CS between those cases differ. Secondly the length of the feature vectors are differently. For the case  $A \neq B$ , the features are computed from the GFN2-xTB quantities with

Eq. (3.2.1). Where  $x$  is a placeholder for any of the quantities shown in Tab. 3.1, but  $R_{AB}$ . This case is called **heteronuclear**, as the Hessian and features depend on two atoms.

$$x_{\text{Arith}} = \frac{x_A + x_B}{2} \quad (3.2.1a)$$

$$x_{\text{Prod}} = x_A \cdot x_B \quad (3.2.1b)$$

$$x_{\text{AbsDiff}} = |x_A - x_B| \quad (3.2.1c)$$

In the case of  $A = B$  the quantities are used directly, and it is called **homonuclear**. Here, the Hessian and features only depend on one atom and  $R_{AB}$  is not used.

Connecting the Hessian elements to the features at this point leads to the following problem. The features for all elements in a Hessian matrix block  $\mathbf{H}_{AB}$  are the same. Therefore, the ML model would predict the same value for every element. Hence, a differentiation is needed for the elements.

The first approach (**indexed**) is the use of three further features  $x_i, y_i, z_i$ . These are indices, which differentiate between each element. In the Appendix in Tab. 7.1 are all indices shown in dependence on the element.

The second approach (**permuted**) is the permutation of the coordinate system and with it the vector/matrix quantities from GFN2-xTB, in dependence of the Hessian elements that shall be learned. The coordinate system is always adjusted, so that the to be learned Hessian element is on the spot of the element  $\frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial y_A \partial x_A}$ . For example, if the element  $\frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial x_A \partial z_A}$  is to be learned. The new coordinate system is permuted from  $\{x, y, z\}$  to  $\{z, x, -y\}$ . The permutation is done in a manner, that the new coordinate system is right-handed. All permutations are described in the Appendix in Tab. 7.2.

For the homonuclear this concludes in 37 or 35 features for each Hessian element for the indexed or permuted case, respectively. And for the heteronuclear model there are 106 or 104 features for each Hessian element for the indexed or permuted case, respectively.

### 3.3 Quantities for Measuring

For first insights on the dependence of the target on the features, the Pearson Correlation Coefficient  $R^2$  (s. Eq. (3.3.1)) can be computed. It describes the linear correlation of the target and the feature. Here,  $x$  is a feature,  $y$  the target and  $\sigma_i$  the standard deviation and  $\bar{i}$  the mean of the feature or target. The values for  $R^2$  are in the range of  $0 \leq R^2 \leq 1$ .

$$R^2 = \left( \frac{\sum_i (x_i - \bar{x}) \cdot \sum_i (y_i - \bar{y})}{\sigma_x \cdot \sigma_y} \right)^2 \quad (3.3.1)$$

For the quantification of the learning process of the ML models the mean squared error MSE (s. Eq. (3.3.2)) was chosen. The ML models are trained with GFN2-xTB based information. Therefore,

the reference is also GFN2-xTB. Here, the target  $y$  corresponds to the Hessian elements, calculated with GFN2-xTB and predicted with the ML model. The number of data points is  $n$ .

$$\text{MSE} = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n (y_{i,\text{ML}} - y_{i,\text{xTB}})^2 \quad (3.3.2)$$

For the comparison of the different models (e.g. ETR-Case-Perm, RFR-Gen-Idx, etc.) the normal distribution is used. For this the difference of a quantity  $q$  between the GFN2-xTB computation and ML model prediction is calculated. Furthermore, the standard deviation  $\sigma$  and mean  $\overline{\Delta q}$  from the difference  $\Delta q$  is computed. After that a normal distribution is assumed and computed with Eq. (3.3.3).

$$f(x) = \frac{1}{\sigma\sqrt{2\pi}} \exp\left(-\frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{q - \overline{\Delta q}}{\sigma}\right)^2\right) \quad (3.3.3)$$

Here,  $q$  is an investigated physical quantity. In this report, the investigated quantities  $q$  the Hessian elements and the wave number  $\tilde{\nu}$ .

In addition to the Hessian elements and the  $\tilde{\nu}$  (s. Eq. (3.3.4a)) the force constant  $k$  (Eq. (3.3.4b)) was examined. Here,  $\lambda$  are the eigenvalues of the mass weighted projected Hessian matrix  $\mathbf{H}^{\text{proj},w|mi}$  and  $m_i$  the mass of each atom. For the transformation into SI-units, the hartree Energy  $E_h$ , planck constant  $h$ , reduced planck constant  $\hbar$ , speed of light  $c$  and the atomic mass unit  $u$  are required.

$$\tilde{\nu} = \sqrt{|\lambda|} \cdot \frac{E_h}{\hbar \cdot c} \quad (3.3.4a)$$

$$k = \frac{E_h^2}{\hbar^2 \cdot u} \cdot \sum_i^M \frac{1}{m_i} \lambda \quad (3.3.4b)$$

### 3.4 Computational Methods

All electronic structure computations were performed with GFN2-xTB<sup>[8]</sup>, for this xtb<sup>[9]</sup> was used. The key words "gfn2", "hess" and "ml\_feature" were passed for the computation of the features and target. The computations were done for every structure in the APF CS. For transformation of the coordinates and the ML models python was used. Especially, the packages sklearn<sup>[6]</sup>, numpy<sup>[10]</sup> and pandas<sup>[11,12]</sup> were used for this project. For the depiction the package matplotlib was used. The versions of the used packages are shown in Tab. 3.2.

Table 3.2: Python modules used for the computation, data storing, constructing the ML model and plotting graphs.

| Package    | Version |
|------------|---------|
| pandas     | 1.4.2   |
| numpy      | 1.22.3  |
| sklearn    | 1.0.2   |
| matplotlib | 3.5.2   |

For the machine learning, the algorithms `RandomForestRegressor` and `ExtraTreeRegressor`, which origin from `sklearn`, were used. The default parameters were used, except the number of estimators was set `n_estimators = 300` for the homonuclear model, and `n_estimators = 100` for the heteronuclear model. No bootstrapping is used in this work. To achieve the split of the target structure wise `GroupShuffleSplit` from `sklearn` was used. For the algorithms and split ten random numbers `random_state ∈ {0, 22, 42, 100, 63, 54, 96, 35, 408, 74}` were used.

## 4 Results and Discussion

### 4.1 The ML Models and Data Set

For every prediction of the Hessian matrix, it is necessary to use the homonuclear and heteronuclear model. Both models were further investigated by three adjustments, namely the algorithms, the labeling and a generalization.

At first, as described in the Chapter Theory, the RFR and ETR are used as the different algorithms for fitting the ML model. Secondly, there are two possibility for the labeling. Either the indexed (Idx) case is used or the permuted (Perm) case. The third adjustment is the distinction between a case specific (Case) and a general (Gen) model. For the case specific models, only one molecular system with different structures is used for the training of a model. While in the general model all molecular systems are used to train one single model. For the further discussion, abbreviations are used for the description of the different variations of the model. As an example, the abbreviation for the model with the ETR as the algorithm, the indexed labeling and general case is ETR-Gen-Idx.

A data set for benchmarking the ML model was constructed. The set consists of eight different molecules. These are namely  $\text{H}_2$ ,  $\text{N}_2$ ,  $\text{O}_2$ ,  $\text{F}_2$ ,  $\text{HF}$ ,  $\text{CO}$ ,  $\text{H}_2\text{O}$ , and  $\text{NH}_3$ . For each molecule, structures with different bond length were generated. Only the distance of one bond was changed for each molecule. This lead into 103 different structures. These structures were split into a training set of 75% and a test set of 25%. The split is done structure wise to achieve the possibility to compare other quantities than the Hessian elements. For each structure, the Hessian and feature were calculated with the GFN2-xTB method.

Moreover, the performance of the model to a complete unknown system is of interest. Therefore, a  $\text{H}_3$ -system was used for this which is predicted by the model. The full data set named above was used as a training set for the model, while the  $\text{H}_3$ -system was used as the test set.

## 4.2 Feature–Target Correlation

For the preparation of the ML models first investigations are done on the linear correlation between the features and target. Thus, the Pearson Correlation Coefficient  $R^2$  was computed for each feature. The used model is Gen-Idx. No algorithm is used, as only the correlation of the computed target and features is investigated. The range of the coefficient is  $0 \leq R^2 \leq 1$ . Ten features with the highest scores are shown in Fig. 4.1 for the homonuclear and heteronuclear model.

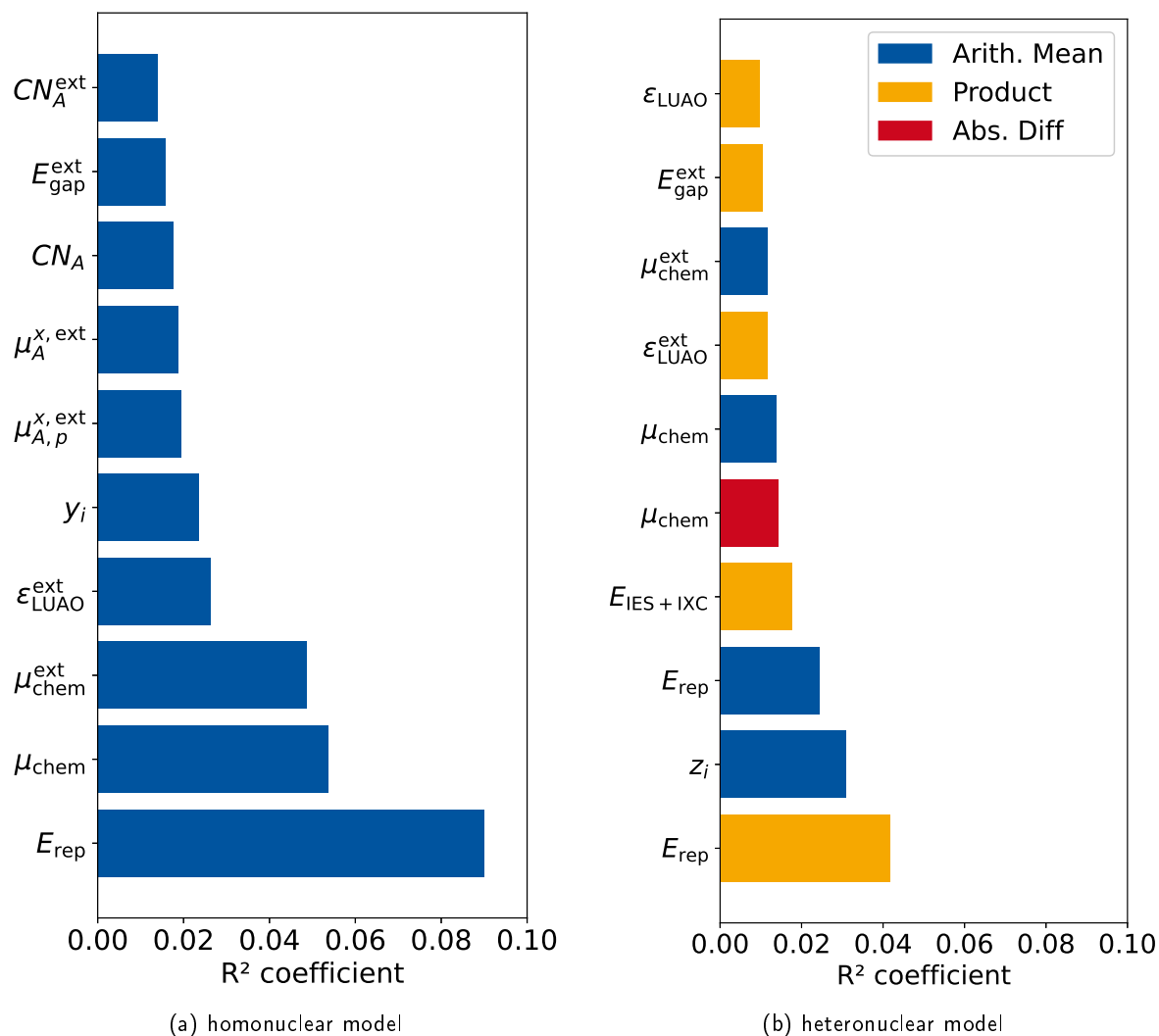


Figure 4.1: Pearson Correlation Coefficient for the features used for the homonuclear and heteronuclear model. The ten features with the highest coefficients are shown for each model.

The highest correlation in the homonuclear model has  $E_{rep}$ . For the heteronuclear model, the product of the repulsion energies has the highest correlation and third highest is the arithmetic mean. Hence, the repulsion seems to be an important feature for the prediction of the Hessian elements. Another high correlation feature is the chemical potential  $\mu_{chem}$ . While, the potential itself is has the second highest correlation, its extension has the third highest for the homonuclear model.

Furthermore, the three variations of  $\mu_{\text{chem}}$  appear also in the heteronuclear model (5., 6., 8.). At last, variations of  $E_{\text{gap}}$  and  $\epsilon_{\text{LUAO}}$  are represented in the highest correlations for both models.

Both models show a correlation of one index  $y_i$  or  $z_i$ . While only the homonuclear model shows a high correlation on the coordination number  $CN_A$  and the atomic dipole moments  $\mu$ , the heteronuclear shows a correlation on the atomic isotropic exchange and correlation energy  $E_{\text{IES+IXC}}$ . However, the correlations are in general rather low. One possible reason is, that the Hessian matrix is sparse, therefore many elements are  $\frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial a_A \partial b_B} \approx 0$  and do not correlate with the given features. This can reduce  $R^2$  significantly. Furthermore, the correlation is computed for all Hessian elements. If the feature correlations of the elements differ from another, the overall correlation is also decreased.

To investigate the last aspect, the target vector was split Hessian element wise. For each Hessian element  $\frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial a_A \partial b_B}$  the Pearson Correlation Coefficients  $R^2$  of the features were computed. For obvious reasons, the indices  $x_i$ ,  $y_i$  and  $z_i$  are not included for this correlation.

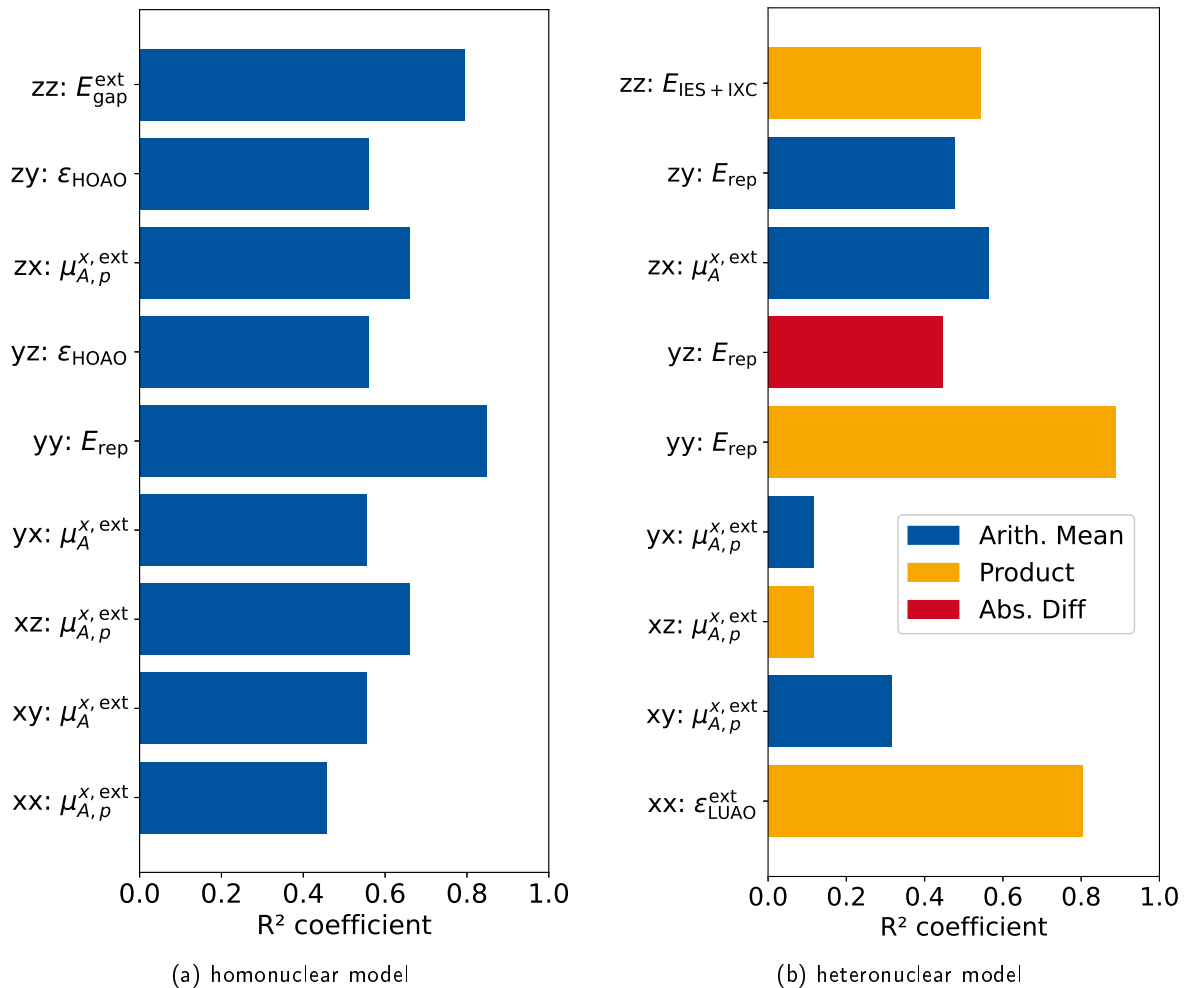


Figure 4.2: Highest Pearson Correlation Coefficient specifically computed for each Hessian element for the homo– and heteronuclear model. The abbreviation ab corresponds to the elements  $\frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial a_A \partial b_B}$ .

Fig 4.2 shows the highest  $R^2$  for each Hessian element for the homo- and heteronuclear model. The elements are abbreviated with the coordinates of the derivative. Comparing the highest  $R^2$  in Fig 4.1 with  $R^2$  in Fig 4.2, there is a significant increase of  $R^2$  for the homonuclear and heteronuclear model. For the heteronuclear model, there are two exceptions, namely for  $yx$  and  $xz$ . Though the element wise  $R^2$  is larger than for the general correlation, the  $R^2$  for  $yx$  and  $xz$  are still in the magnitude of the general correlation. Interesting to point out, is that most of the features which show element wise the highest correlation are also presented in the ten highest  $R^2$  for the general correlation. Exceptions are for the homonuclear model  $\epsilon_{\text{H} \text{AO} \text{A}}$ , and for the heteronuclear model  $\mu_{\text{A}}^{\text{x,ext}}_{\text{Arith}}$ ,  $\mu_{\text{A},p}^{\text{x,ext}}_{\text{Prod}}$ ,  $E_{\text{repAbs.Diff}}$ . Regarding only the element wise  $R^2$  for the homonuclear model, the element pairs  $(xy, yx)$ ,  $(zx, xz)$  and  $(zy, yz)$  have the same correlation. This is due to the fact, that the Hessian matrix block  $\mathbf{H}_{\text{AA}}$  is symmetric. Moreover, the highest correlations do differ from another for each element, except for the symmetric element pairs. This is especially important for the machine learning, as this suggest, that the elements can be differentiated with the used features. The computations are also done for the model Gen-Perm and shown in Fig 7.4 and Fig 7.5.

### 4.3 The H<sub>2</sub> system

As a first approach, the ETR–Case–Perm model was used for the subset of the hydrogen molecule. Here, the wave numbers  $\tilde{\nu}_{\text{ML}}$  were predicted and plotted against the via GFN2–xTB calculated wave numbers  $\tilde{\nu}_{\text{xTB}}$ . This is done for 5 random states and is shown in Fig. 4.3. The black line is the diagonal, on which the data points would appear for a perfect prediction. Furthermore, the wave number increases with the decrease of the bond length. For the approximated range of  $1800 \text{ cm}^{-1} < \tilde{\nu}_{\text{xTB}} < 7500 \text{ cm}^{-1}$  there are small deviations from the diagonal and therefore, in respect to the small data set of eleven structures, a sufficient prediction.

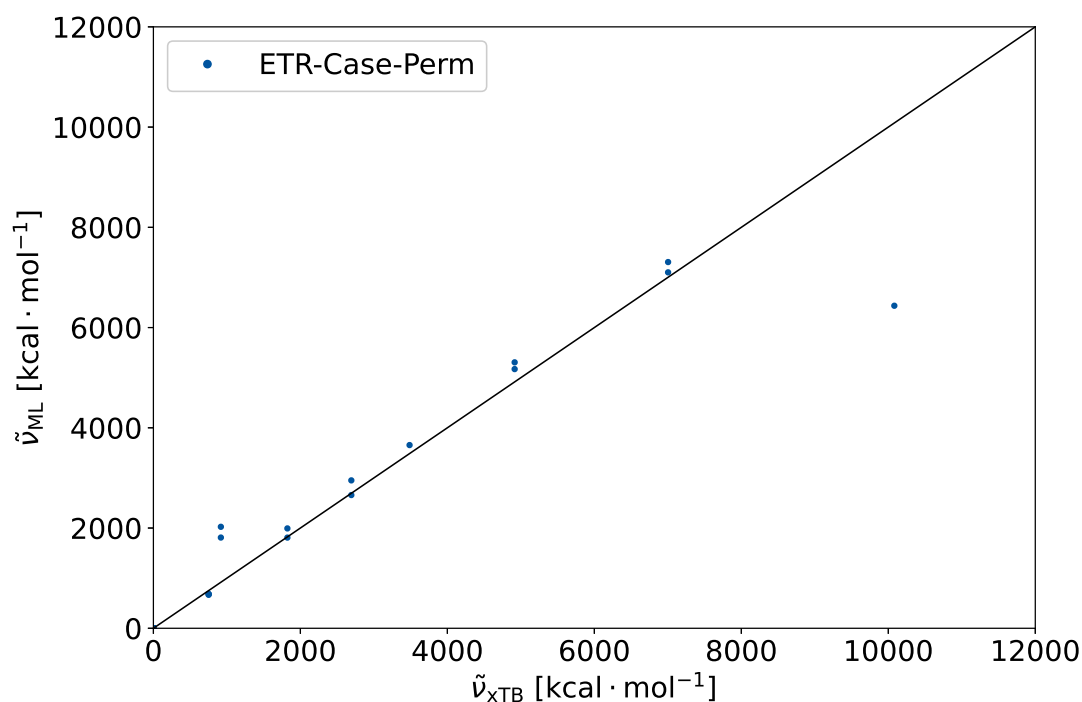


Figure 4.3: The wavenumber, predicted via the ML model  $\tilde{\nu}_{\text{ML}}$  is plotted against the wave number calculated via GFN2–xTB  $\tilde{\nu}_{\text{xTB}}$ . The model uses the Extra Tree Regression. The sample set is H<sub>2</sub> and the training set is 75 % of the whole set. The prediction were done for 5 random states.

The deviations are stronger in the cases of  $1800 \text{ cm}^{-1} > \tilde{\nu}_{\text{xTB}}$ . For  $\tilde{\nu}_{\text{xTB}} > 7500 \text{ cm}^{-1}$  there is an outlier. These predictions are done for cases, where the training set does not include molecules, which have a lower or higher distance, respectively. Hence, it can be assumed, that the error is due to extrapolation of the ML model. This assumption is underlined by the fact, that the predicted values correspond to the next higher or lower value. For example, the next lowest value in the case of the prediction at  $\tilde{\nu}_{\text{xTB}} \approx 1 \cdot 10^5 \text{ cm}^{-1}$  is  $\tilde{\nu}_{\text{xTB}} \approx 7 \cdot 10^4 \text{ cm}^{-1}$ . This in the same order as the predicted value  $\tilde{\nu}_{\text{ML}} \approx 6.4 \cdot 10^4 \text{ cm}^{-1}$  at  $\tilde{\nu}_{\text{xTB}} \approx 1 \cdot 10^5 \text{ cm}^{-1}$ . This matches to the expected behavior for a decision tree based algorithms (cf. Fig. 2.2).

This concludes in the sufficient description of the wave numbers for interpolation. It could also be

shown, that the prediction fails for extrapolation.

## 4.4 Comparison of RFR and ETR

For the comparison of the algorithms, the RFR–Gen–Perm and ETR–Gen–Perm models were used. These models are compared to each other by testing their dependency on the amount of training set used. As the quantity for testing the performance the MSE between the predicted Hessian and the Hessian computed via GFN2–xTB is used. The MSE was calculated for ten different random states and the mean and standard deviation of these MSE was calculated.

It is expected, that the performance of the ML model should increase, the more data it is trained with. This can be interpreted as a statistical learning behavior. To verify this behavior, the training set was increased successively. The full training set is 75 % of the full data set. Thus, the test set is 25 % of the data set. The *Amount of Training set used* = 1 corresponds to 75 %. While keeping the test set constant, the amount of training set is changed successively between 0.1 of the data set to 1.0. Fig 4.4 shows the MSE in the dependency of the amount of training set used for the ETR (on the left) and the RFR (on the right). The error bars indicate the standard deviation.

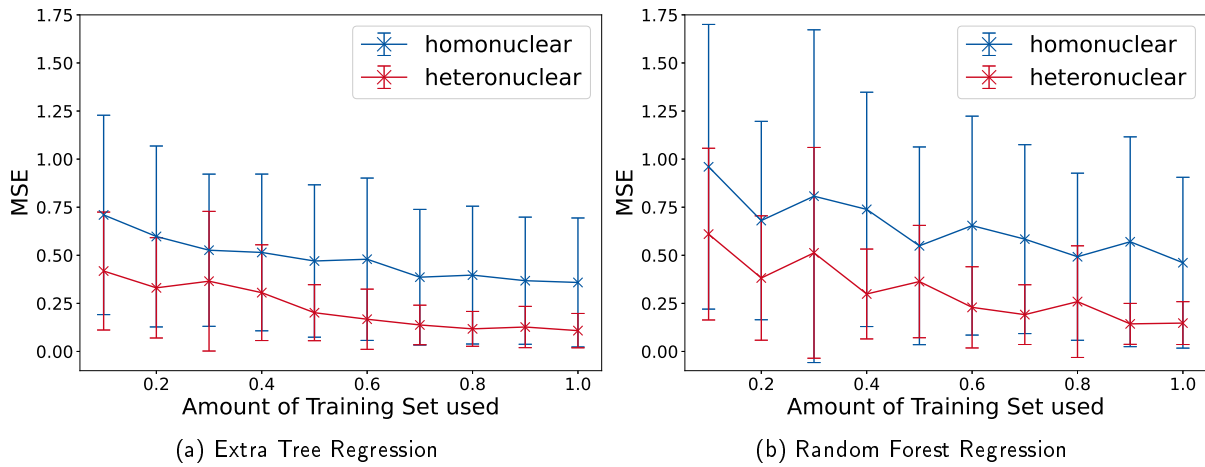


Figure 4.4: Learning plots for the predicting Hessian elements  $\frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial a \partial b}$  for an increase of the amount of training set used. On the left is the learning plot of the Extra Tree Regression and on the right the plot of the Random Forest Regression shown. The full training set is 75 % of the sample set. The full sample set, excluding the  $H_3$  system, is used. The mean of ten random states were used for the MSE. The plots are done for the homonuclear model (blue) and heteronuclear model (red).

In the case of the ETR, the MSE decreases with an increase of the amount of training set used for the homonuclear and heteronuclear model. This behavior is also recognizable in the case of the RFR. In comparison to the ETR, the RFR shows a higher standard deviation for the data points. Thus, the RFR depends more strongly on the random state than the ETR. Furthermore, the ETR has, especially for the homonuclear model, lower MSE values for any amount of training set. For the Amount of

Training Set used  $\geq 0.9$ , the RFR and ETR show a similar performance for the heteronuclear model. All in all, the ETR shows a better performance for the whole investigated range.

There is the possibility, that the ML model has so much information in the features, that it can always predict the target. Hence, the model is tested on whether this is the case, or the ML model learns from the information of the feature. For this, the features are scattered with a random factor. The intensity of the scattering is amplified by the factor  $\sigma$ . It is expected, that a model that learns from the features performs worse, if the scattering of the data points increases. The performance of the model ETR–Multi–Perm was tested for this and is shown in Fig 4.5.

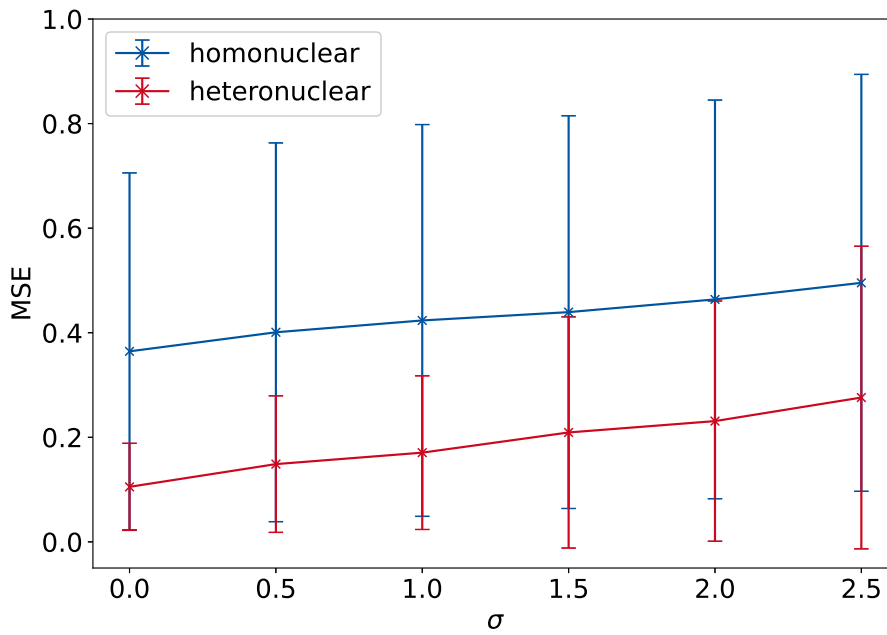


Figure 4.5: Learning plots for predicting Hessian elements  $\frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial a \partial b}$  for a variation of the factor  $\sigma$ . The full sample set, excluding the  $H_3$  system, is used for the ML models. The mean of ten random states were used for the MSE. The plots are done for the homonuclear model (blue) and heteronuclear model (red).

The prediction was done for ten different random states. The MSE between the predicted Hessian elements and the via GFN2–xTB calculated ones was investigated. For the investigated range of  $0 \leq \sigma \leq 2.5$  the MSE increases monotonically. Hence, this shows, that the model learns from the features and is not purely random.

In this section a comparison of the RFR and ETR was done. The ETR shows overall a better performance than the RFR. Furthermore, it could be verified, that the ML model learns statistically from the features used for the prediction of the Hessian matrices.

## 4.5 Comparison of Permutation Model and Indexed Model

Beside the different algorithms for the construction of the trees, the models with the variations of Gen/Case and Idx/Perm were compared. Here, the models ETR–Gen–Perm, ETR–Gen–Idx, ETR–Case–Perm and ETR–Case–Idx are investigated. The quantities for measuring are the Hessian elements and the wave numbers of the harmonic vibration. The difference between the predicted and via GFN2–xTB computed quantities were computed. From these differences the standard deviation as also the mean were calculated, and a Gaussian distribution was assumed. At first the direct prediction of the Hessian elements were investigated, and its distribution is shown in Fig 4.6.

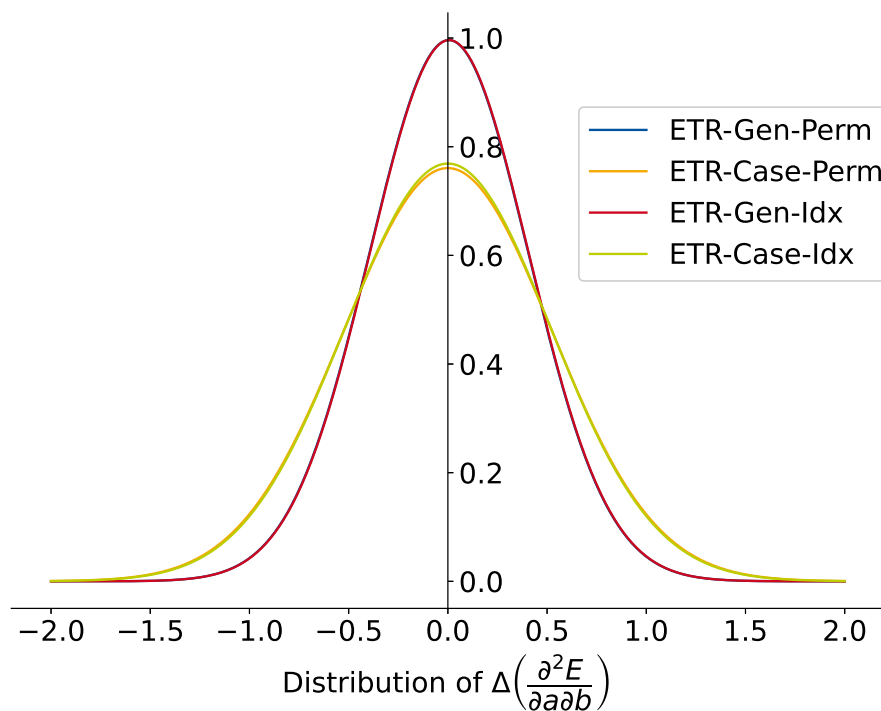


Figure 4.6: Distribution of  $\Delta\left(\frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial a \partial b}\right)$  for different models. In every model, the Extra Tree Regression was used. The distribution is assumed to be Gaussian type. For this the median and standard deviation of  $\Delta\left(\frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial a \partial b}\right)$  are computed.

Comparing the ETR–Case–Perm and ETR–Case–Idx, as also ETR–Gen–Perm and ETR–Gen–Idx shows, that both approaches for the labeling of the features do not differ significantly. Hence, both approaches are in good agreement with another. This shows, on the one hand, the strength of the decision tree algorithms.

They cannot overfit and seem to be capable of describing this complex system with a simple differentiation by indexes. On the other hand, the permuted model does the same prediction for the model, but may be useful for other machine learning algorithms or even neural networks.

The comparison of the ETR-Case-Perm and ETR-Gen-Perm shows, that the ETR-Case-Perm model deviates more strongly. This is in agreement with the comparison of the ETR-Case-Idx and ETR-Gen-Idx models. Though the deviation is stronger, the means of the models do not differ significantly. The data set for training the models is smaller for the case-specific models than for the general models. This might be the reason for the deviation.

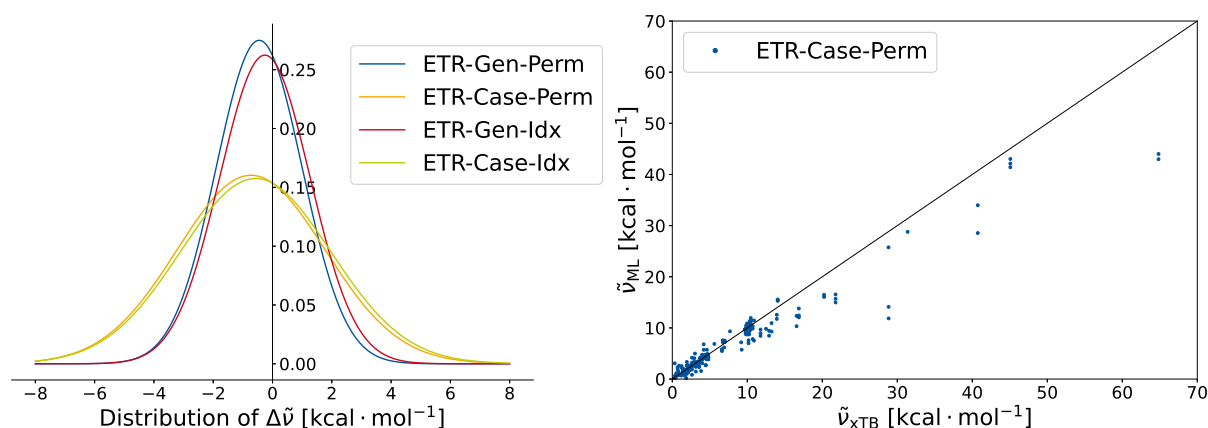


Figure 4.7: On the left is the distribution of  $\Delta\tilde{\nu}$  for different models. In every model, the Extra Tree Regression was used. The distribution is assumed to be Gaussian type. For this the median and standard deviation of  $\Delta\tilde{\nu}$  are computed. On the right is the  $\tilde{\nu}_{ML}$  plotted against  $\tilde{\nu}_{xTB}$ . The wave numbers are predicted with the ETR-Gen-Perm model.

The wave numbers  $\tilde{\nu}$  of the harmonic frequencies of the molecules were calculated. The difference between the difference between the ML predicted  $\tilde{\nu}_{ML}$  and the via GFN2-xTB computed  $\tilde{\nu}_{xTB}$  was calculated. A Gaussian distribution was assumed. This is plotted in Fig. 4.7 for the four different varieties of the model. Furthermore, the plot of the  $\tilde{\nu}_{ML}$  vs.  $\tilde{\nu}_{xTB}$  is shown. The relative distributions of the four variations of the models are similar to the ones of the Hessian elements. The ETR-Gen-Perm and ETR-Gen-Idx show a better performance than the ETR-Case-Perm and the ETR-Case-Idx. The mean is shifted to a negative  $\Delta\tilde{\nu}$ . In contrast to the Gaussian distribution of the Hessian elements, the Idx models show a marginal better performance than the Perm model. The deviations of several kcal · mol<sup>-1</sup> are rather strong. These strong deviations might be due to high extrapolation errors, which lead to high standard distribution. For example at  $\tilde{\nu}_{xTB} \approx 65 \text{ kcal} \cdot \text{mol}^{-1}$  the deviation might be due to extrapolation. Hence, the difference of about  $\Delta\tilde{\nu} \approx 20 \text{ kcal} \cdot \text{mol}^{-1}$  has a strong influence on the distribution, although ML is not customized for extrapolation problems.

Contrary to the extrapolation errors are the wave numbers, which correspond to rotation and translation. These wave numbers are approximately zero and have large contribution to number of wave numbers. Therefore, they narrow the standard deviation, and shift the mean to zero. Further investigations are necessary, to see whether the extrapolation or the wave numbers, corresponding to rotation and translation, have a higher impact onto the mean and standard deviation.

## 4.6 Benchmarking with the $H_3$ system

Especially, the prediction of Hessian matrices of fully unknown systems is of interest. Hence, the ETR-Gen-Perm and ETR-Gen-Idx models were tested on the performance on a new, for the model unknown, system. For the  $H_3$  system the outer hydrogen atoms were fixed, while the inner hydrogen atom was shift from one hydrogen to another. H1 is fixed at  $x(H1) = 0.0 \text{ \AA}$  and H3 at  $x(H1) = 4.0 \text{ \AA}$ . For each position of the hydrogen atom, the force constants of the systems were predict via the ML model. The force constants were also calculated via GFN2-xTB.

Fig. 4.8 shows the force constants calculated by GFN2-xTB and predicted via the ETR-Gen-Idx model. Interesting to point out is the symmetric behavior of the system. The ML model should, in principle, mimic this behavior.

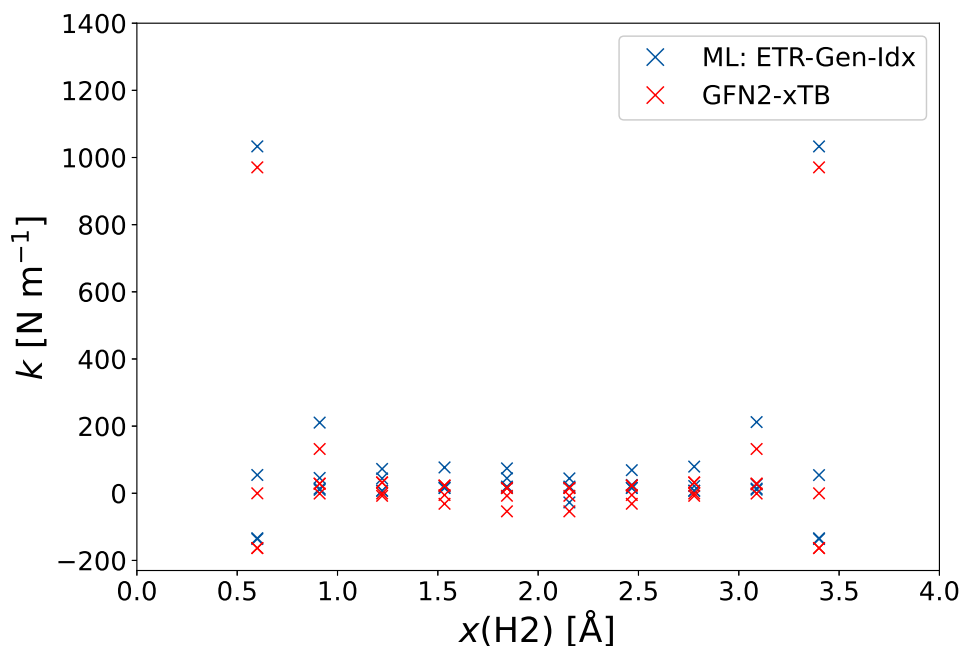


Figure 4.8: Force constants predicted for the  $H_3$  systems in dependence of the distance between H1 and H2 are shown. H1 is located at  $x(H1) = 0.0 \text{ \AA}$  and H3 at  $x(H1) = 4.0 \text{ \AA}$ . The force constants are shown for the GFN2-xTB calculation (red), as also the via the ML model predicted values (blue). The full sample set, excluding the  $H_3$  system, was used for the ML model. The ML model ETR-Gen-Idx was used for the prediction.

While this is overall the case, there are deviations from this behavior. For the example, the symmetry is not given in the case of  $x(\text{H2}) = 1.84 \text{ \AA}$  and  $x(\text{H2}) = 2.15 \text{ \AA}$ .

Fig. 4.9 shows the prediction of the force constants via the ETR-Gen-Perm model. Similar to the ETR-Gen-Idx model, the symmetry is in general achieved. Nevertheless, for example the force constants at  $x(\text{H2}) = 0.91 \text{ \AA}$  and  $x(\text{H2}) = 3.08 \text{ \AA}$  show deviations from one another.

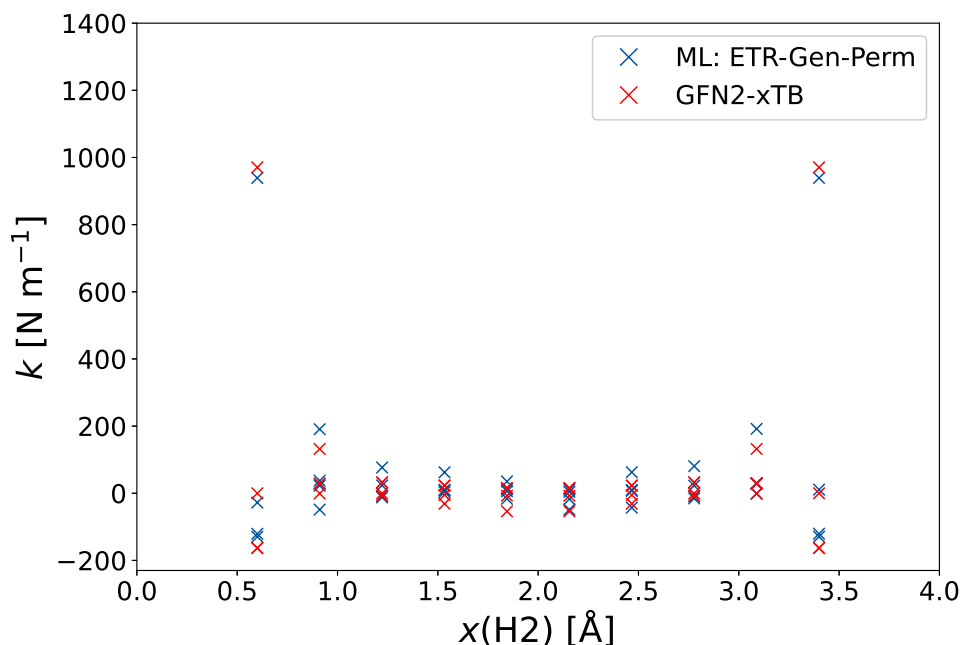


Figure 4.9: Force constants predicted for the  $\text{H}_3$  systems in dependence of the distance between  $\text{H1}$  and  $\text{H2}$  are shown.  $\text{H1}$  is located at  $x(\text{H1}) = 0.0 \text{ \AA}$  and  $\text{H3}$  at  $x(\text{H1}) = 4.0 \text{ \AA}$ . The force constants are shown for the GFN2-xTB calculation (red), as also the via the ML model predicted values (blue). The full sample set, excluding the  $\text{H}_3$  system, was used for the ML model. The ML model ETR-Gen-Perm was used for the prediction.

An overall sufficient prediction of the force constants was achieved, though there are still errors in the symmetry. Further investigations on the models are necessary, to locate the reason for the break of symmetry. Worth considering are the rotation process, the homonuclear and heteronuclear model. The rotation process can be neglected, as rotation is also done for the GFN2-xTB calculations. A decoupled investigation of the homonuclear and heteronuclear model is therefore necessary.

## 5 Conclusion & Outlook

The goal of the research was the prediction of Hessian matrices by a machine learning model. The machine learning model was based on atomic features and the prediction of the elements of the Hessian matrices was done atom pair wise. The model was benchmarked by a small data set of 8 molecules with 103 different structures. The computations of the Hessian matrices and features for these systems was done with the GFN2-xTB method.

In the first place, the general learning of the model was investigated. A statistical learning behavior of the ML models RFR-Gen-Perm and ETR-Gen-Perm could be observed. Compared to another, the ETR-Gen-Perm model showed a better performance. Furthermore, a physical correlation could be presented for the ETR-Gen-Perm model.

Moreover, four variations of the model were investigated and compared to another, which are the models ETR-Gen/Case-Perm/Idx. Here, a similar behavior for different labeling approaches (Indexed and Permuted) was shown. The general models show a better prediction than the case-specific models. For this, the Hessian elements, zero point vibrational energy and wave numbers were predicted.

In addition, the set was used for the prediction of a system, that is unknown to the ML model.

The data set of the new H<sub>3</sub> system shows an almost symmetric behavior for the force constants, which could, with some minor errors, be depicted by the ML models.

The next necessary approaches for this research, is the improvement of the models in their symmetric behavior. Although, for the H<sub>3</sub> system the errors in symmetry are minor, the adjustment to a full symmetric behavior is mandatory. As the correlation of the features is low, investigations towards higher correlating features might increase the performance of the ML models. Here, new functions could be used, which achieve a linear correlation between the features and target. In addition, a set of 103 structures is small for a ML model. Hence, the date set size should be increased and tests on benchmark data sets should be done for a comparison to literature. When the prediction of the Hessian matrix on GFN2-xTB level is sufficient, the model can be adapted to a  $\Delta$ ML model.

## 6 Bibliography

- [1] S. Spicher and S. Grimme, "Single-point hessian calculations for improved vibrational frequencies and rigid-rotor-harmonic-oscillator thermodynamics," *Journal of Chemical Theory and Computation*, vol. 17, no. 3, pp. 1701–1714, 2021, PMID: 33554604. DOI: 10.1021/acs.jctc.0c01306.
- [2] J. N. Sanders, X. Andrade, and A. Aspuru-Guzik, "Compressed sensing for the fast computation of matrices: Application to molecular vibrations," *ACS Central Science*, vol. 1, no. 1, pp. 24–32, Mar. 2015. DOI: 10.1021/oc5000404.
- [3] F. Jensen, *Introduction to Computational Chemistry*. New York: John Wiley & Sons, 2013, ISBN: 978-1-118-68162-6.
- [4] T. Hastie, R. Tibshirani, and J. Friedman, *The Elements of Statistical Learning - Data Mining, Inference, and Prediction, Second Edition*. Berlin Heidelberg: Springer Science & Business Media, 2009, ISBN: 978-0-387-84858-7.
- [5] P. Geurts, D. Ernst, and L. Wehenkel, "Extremely randomized trees," *Machine Learning*, vol. 63, no. 1, pp. 3–42, Mar. 2006. DOI: 10.1007/s10994-006-6226-1.
- [6] F. Pedregosa *et al.*, "Scikit-learn: Machine learning in Python," *Journal of Machine Learning Research*, vol. 12, pp. 2825–2830, 2011.
- [7] P. Steinbach, "A  $\Delta$ -machine learning quantum chemical approach based on semiempirical electronic structure theory," M.S. thesis, RWTH Aachen University, 2021.
- [8] C. Bannwarth, S. Ehlert, and S. Grimme, "GFN2-xTB—an accurate and broadly parametrized self-consistent tight-binding quantum chemical method with multipole electrostatics and density-dependent dispersion contributions," *Journal of Chemical Theory and Computation*, vol. 15, no. 3, pp. 1652–1671, Feb. 2019. DOI: 10.1021/acs.jctc.8b01176.
- [9] C. Bannwarth *et al.*, "Extended tight-binding quantum chemistry methods," *WIREs Computational Molecular Science*, vol. 11, no. 2, e1493, 2021. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1002/wcms.1493>.
- [10] C. R. Harris *et al.*, "Array programming with NumPy," *Nature*, vol. 585, no. 7825, pp. 357–362, Sep. 2020. DOI: 10.1038/s41586-020-2649-2.
- [11] W. McKinney, "Data Structures for Statistical Computing in Python," in *Proceedings of the 9th Python in Science Conference*, S. van der Walt and J. Millman, Eds., 2010, pp. 56–61. DOI: 10.25080/Majora-92bf1922-00a.

[12] J. Reback *et al.*, *Pandas-dev/pandas: Pandas 1.4.2*, 2022. DOI: 10.5281/ZENODO.3509134.

## 7 Appendix

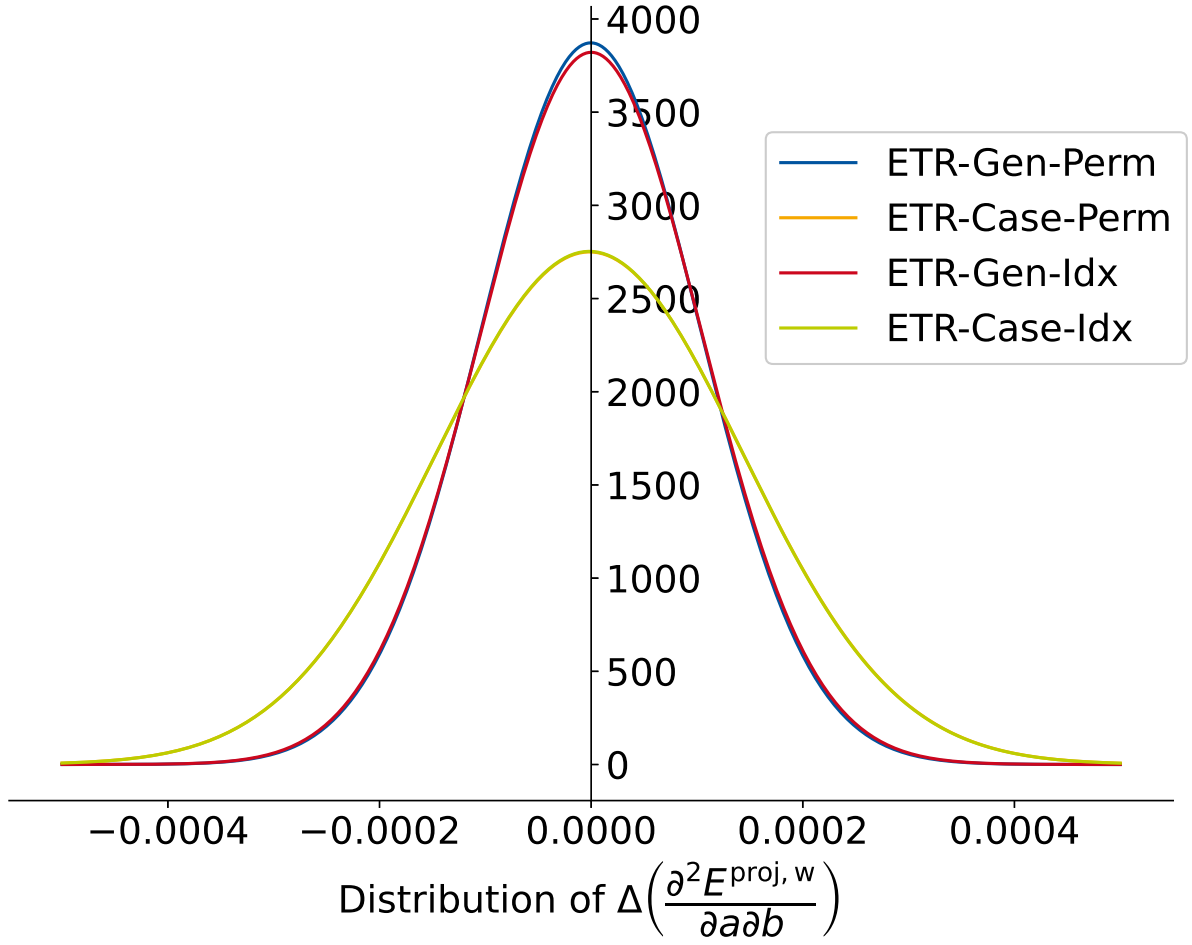


Figure 7.1: Distribution of  $\Delta\left(\frac{\partial^2 E^{\text{proj},w}}{\partial a \partial b}\right)$  for different models. In every model, the Extra Tree Regression was used. The distribution is assumed to be Gaussian type. For this the median and standard deviation of  $\Delta\left(\frac{\partial^2 E^{\text{proj},w}}{\partial a \partial b}\right)$  are computed.

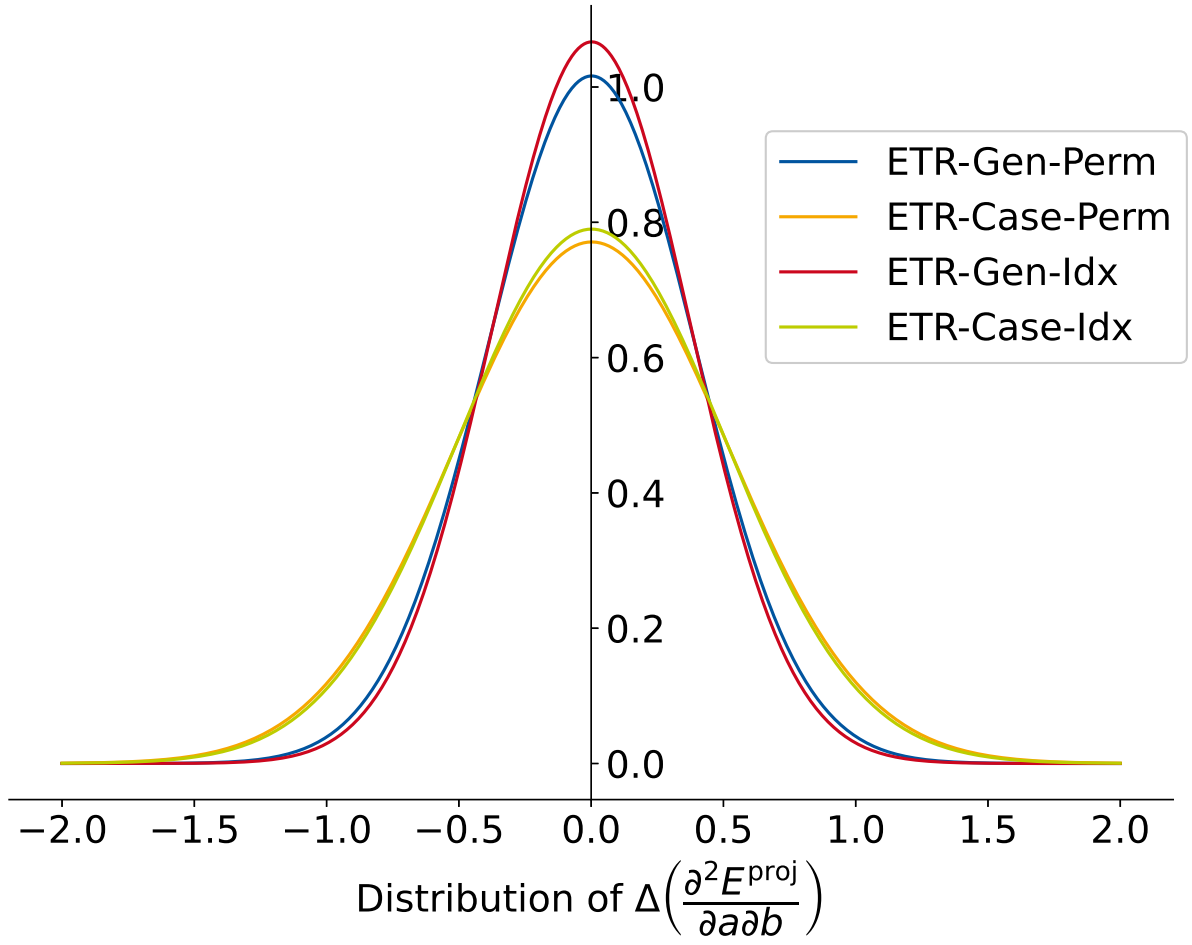


Figure 7.2: Distribution of  $\Delta\left(\frac{\partial^2 E^{\text{proj}}}{\partial a \partial b}\right)$  for different models. In every model, the Extra Tree Regression was used. The distribution is assumed to be Gaussian type. For this the median and standard deviation of  $\Delta\left(\frac{\partial^2 E^{\text{proj}}}{\partial a \partial b}\right)$  are computed.

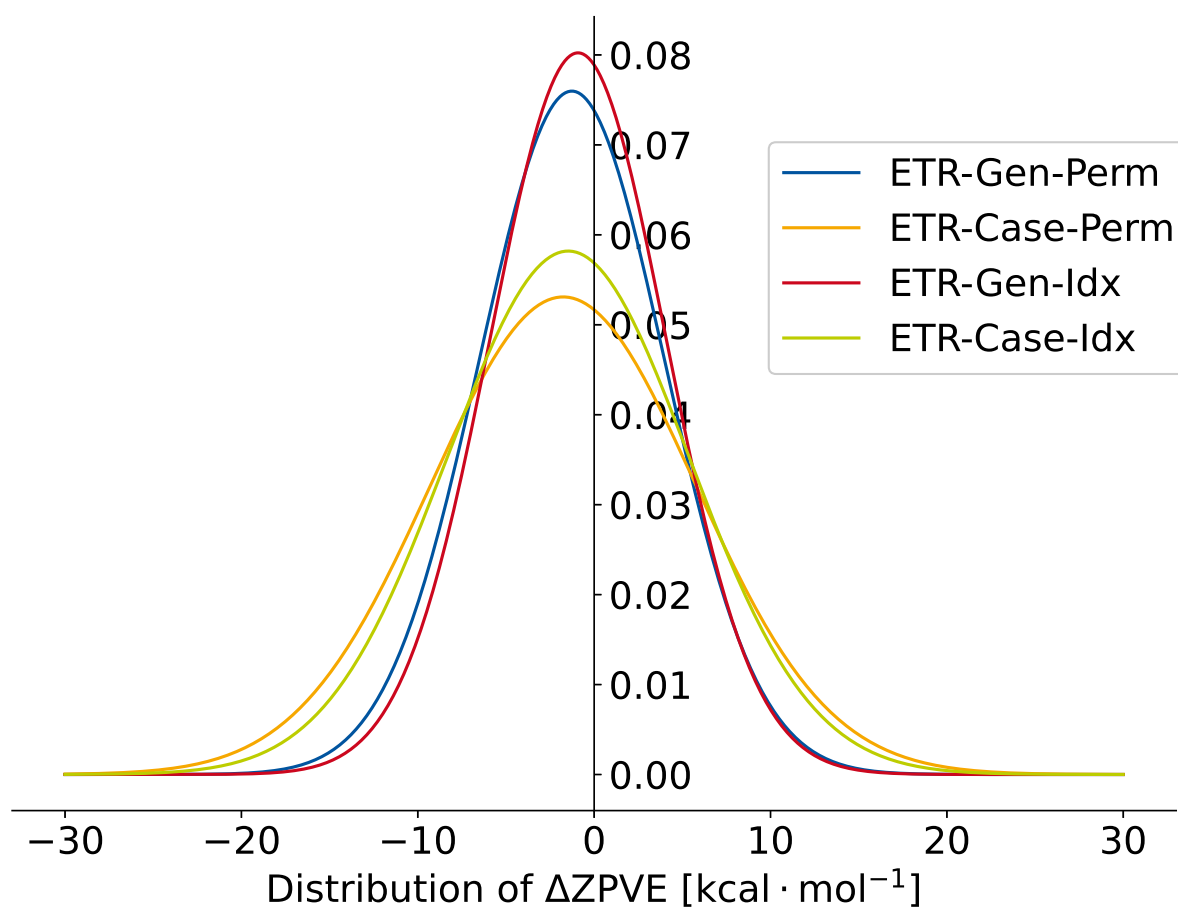


Figure 7.3: Distribution of  $\Delta ZPE$  for different models. In every model, the Extra Tree Regression was used. The distribution is assumed to be Gaussian type. For this the median and standard deviation of  $\Delta ZPE$  are computed.

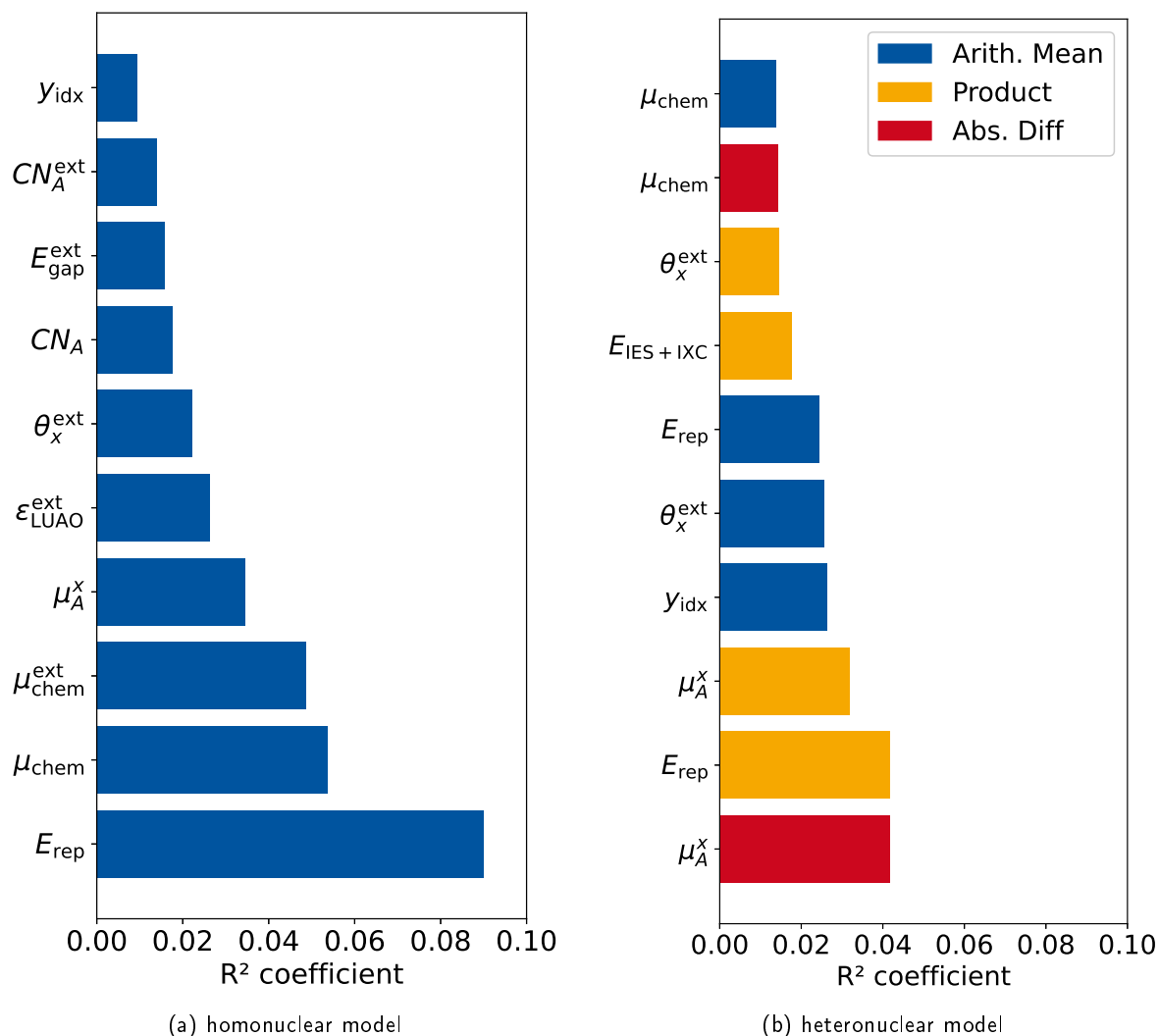


Figure 7.4: Pearson Correlation Coefficient for the features used for the homonuclear and heteronuclear model. The ten features with the highest coefficients are shown for each model. The features are constructed with the Gen-Perm model.

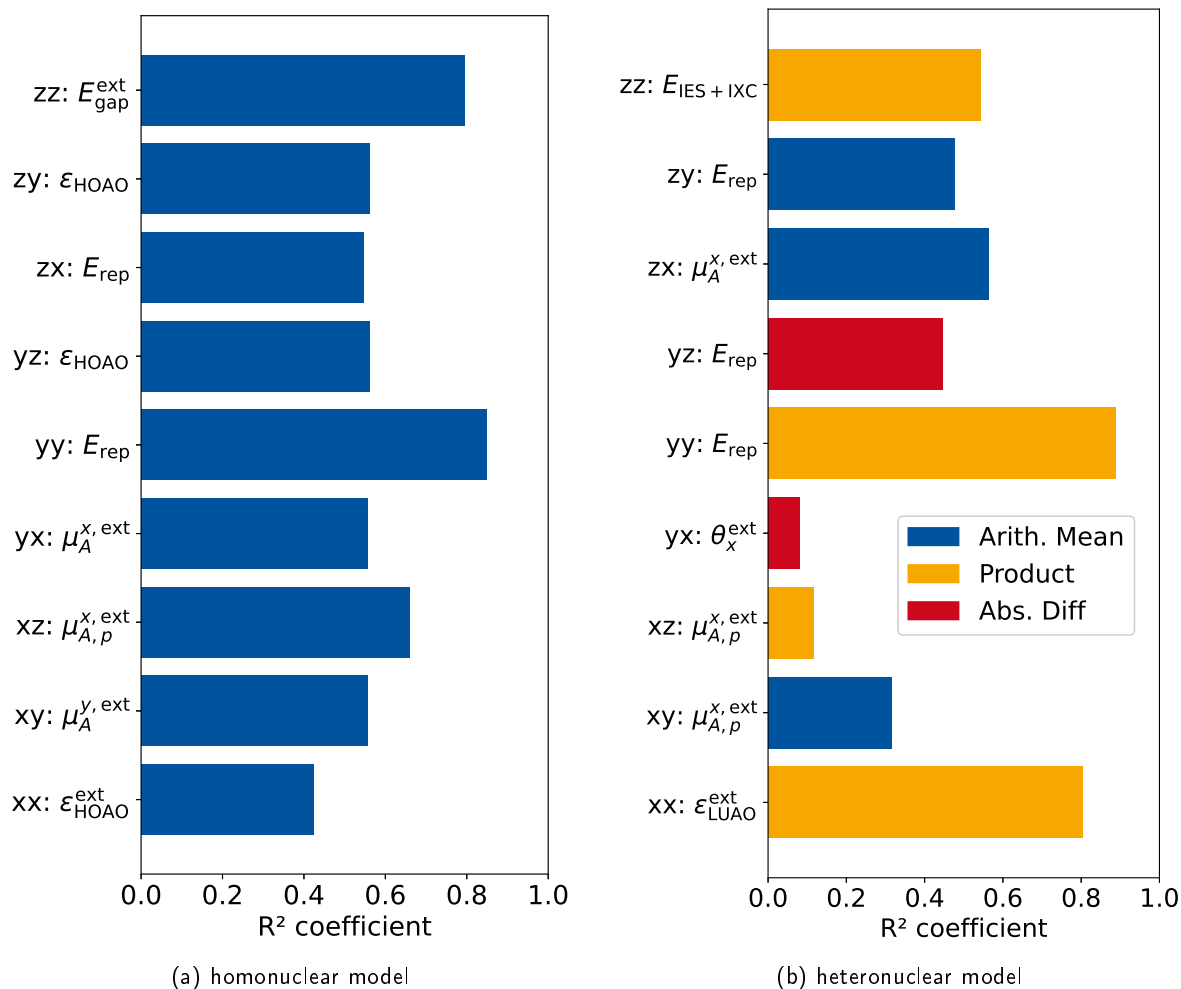


Figure 7.5: Highest Pearson Correlation Coefficient specifically computed for each Hessian element for the homo- and heteronuclear model. The abbreviation ab corresponds to the elements  $\frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial a_A \partial b_B}$ . The features are constructed with the Gen-Perm model.

$$CN_A = \sum_{B \neq A}^{N_{\text{atoms}}} \frac{1}{1 + \exp\left(\frac{-16a \cdot 4(R_{A,\text{cov}} + R_{B,\text{cov}})}{3R_{AB} - 1}\right)} \quad (7.0.1a)$$

$$CN^{\text{ext}} = \sum_{B \neq A}^{N_{\text{atoms}}} \frac{CN_B}{f_{\text{damp}}(R_A, R_B)} \quad (7.0.1b)$$

$$q_A = Zg_A - \sum_{\mu \in A}^{N_{\text{BF}}} \sum_{\nu}^{N_{\text{BF}}} P_{\mu\nu} S_{\mu\nu} \quad (7.0.1c)$$

$$q_A^{\text{ext}} = q_A + \sum_{B \neq A}^{N_{\text{atoms}}} \frac{q_B}{f_{\text{damp}}} \quad (7.0.1d)$$

$$\mu_A^\alpha = \sum_{I \in A} \sum_{\kappa \in I \in A} \sum_{\lambda} P_{\kappa\lambda} (\alpha_A S_{\lambda\kappa} - D_{\lambda\kappa}^\alpha) \quad (7.0.1e)$$

$$\mu_A^{\alpha, \text{ext}} = \mu_A^\alpha + \sum_{B \neq A} \frac{\mu_B^\alpha - \alpha_{AB} q_B}{f_{\text{damp}} \cdot (CN_B + 1)} \quad (7.0.1f)$$

$$\text{with : } \alpha_{AB} = \alpha_A - \alpha_B \quad (7.0.1g)$$

$$\mu_{A,p}^{\alpha, \text{ext}} = \mu_A^\alpha + \sum_{B \neq A} \frac{\mu_B^\alpha + \alpha_{AB} p_B}{f_{\text{damp}}(CN_B + 1)} \quad (7.0.1h)$$

$$\theta_A^{\alpha\beta} = \sum_{I \in A} \frac{3}{2} \Theta_I^{\alpha\beta} - \frac{\delta^{\alpha\beta}}{2} (\Theta_I^{\text{xx}} + \Theta_I^{\text{yy}} + \Theta_I^{\text{zz}}) \quad (7.0.1i)$$

$$\text{with : } \Theta_I^{\alpha\beta} = \sum_{\kappa \in I \in A} \sum_A P_{\kappa\lambda} (\alpha_A D_{\lambda\kappa}^\beta + \beta_A D_{\lambda\kappa}^\alpha - \alpha_A \beta_A S_{\lambda\kappa} - Q_{\lambda\kappa}^{\alpha\beta})$$

$$\text{and : } \delta^{\alpha\beta} = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if : } \alpha = \beta \\ 0 & \text{if : } \alpha \neq \beta \end{cases}$$

$$\Theta_A = \begin{pmatrix} \theta_A^{\text{xx}} & \theta_A^{\text{xy}} & \theta_A^{\text{xz}} \\ \theta_A^{\text{xy}} & \theta_A^{\text{yy}} & \theta_A^{\text{yz}} \\ \theta_A^{\text{xz}} & \theta_A^{\text{yz}} & \theta_A^{\text{zz}} \end{pmatrix} \times \mathbf{1} \quad (7.0.1j)$$

$$\theta_A^{\text{ext}, \alpha\beta} = \theta_A^{\alpha\beta} + \frac{\theta_B^{\alpha\beta} + \delta \theta_B^{\alpha\beta}}{f_{\text{damp}}(CN_B + 1)} \quad (7.0.1k)$$

$$\Theta_A^{\text{ext}} = \begin{pmatrix} \theta_A^{\text{ext}, \text{xx}} & \theta_A^{\text{ext}, \text{xy}} & \theta_A^{\text{ext}, \text{xz}} \\ \theta_A^{\text{ext}, \text{xy}} & \theta_A^{\text{ext}, \text{yy}} & \theta_A^{\text{ext}, \text{yz}} \\ \theta_A^{\text{ext}, \text{xz}} & \theta_A^{\text{ext}, \text{yz}} & \theta_A^{\text{ext}, \text{zz}} \end{pmatrix} \times \mathbf{1} \quad (7.0.1l)$$

$$E_{A,\text{EHT}} = \sum_{k \in A} \sum_k P_{k\lambda} H_{k\lambda} \quad (7.0.1m)$$

$$E_{A,\text{rep}} = \sum_{B \neq A}^M \frac{1}{2} \frac{Y_A^{\text{eff}} Y_B^{\text{eff}}}{R_{AB}} \cdot \exp(\alpha_A \alpha_B)^{0.5} R_{AB}^{k_{\text{rep}}} \quad (7.0.1n)$$

$$E_{A,\text{disp}}^{(2)} = \sum_{A \neq B} \sum_{n=6,8} -s_n \frac{1}{2} \frac{C_n^{AB}(q_a, CN_{\text{cov}}^A, q_b, CN_{\text{cov}}^B)}{R_{AB}^n} f_n^{\text{damp,BJ}}(R_{AB}) \quad (7.0.1o)$$

$$E_{A,\text{disp}}^{(3)} = \sum_{B \neq A} \sum_{C \neq B \neq A} -s_9 \frac{1}{3} \frac{(3 \cos(\theta_{ABC}) \cos(\theta_{BCA}) \cos(\theta_{CBA}) + 1)}{(R_{AB} R_{AC} R_{BC})^3} \\ \cdot C_9^{ABC}(CN_{\text{cov}}^A, CN_{\text{cov}}^B, CN_{\text{cov}}^C) \cdot f_9^{\text{damp,zero}}(R_{AB}, R_{AC}, R_{BC}) \quad (7.0.1p)$$

$$E_{A,\text{AES}} = E_{A,q\mu} + E_{A,q\theta} + E_{A,\mu\mu} \\ = \sum_{B \neq A} \frac{1}{2} \left( f_3(R_{AB}) [q_A (\mu_B^T \mathbf{R}_{BA}) + q_B (\mu_A^T \mathbf{R}_{AB})] \right. \\ \left. + f_5(R_{AB}) [q_A \mathbf{R}_{BA}^T \mathbf{\Theta}_B \mathbf{R}_{BA} + q_B \mathbf{R}_{BA}^T \mathbf{\Theta}_A \mathbf{R}_{BA} \right. \\ \left. - 3(\mu_A^T \mathbf{R}_{AB})(\mu_B^T \mathbf{R}_{AB}) + (\mu_A^T \mu_B R_{AB}^2) \right] \quad (7.0.1q)$$

$$E_{A,\text{AXS}} = \left( f_{\text{XC}}^{\mu_A} |\mu_A|^2 + f_{\text{XC}}^{\Theta_A} \|\mathbf{\Theta}_A\|^2 \right) \quad (7.0.1r)$$

$$E_{A,\text{IES+IXC}} = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{B \neq A} \sum_{I \in A} \sum_{I' \in B} q_{A,I} q_{B,I'} \gamma_{AB,I I'} + \frac{1}{3} \sum_{I \in A} \Gamma_{A,I} q_{A,I}^3 \quad (7.0.1s)$$

Table 7.1: Indices used for the different elements in a Hessian matrix block to differ between the elements.

| Hessian element                                  | $x^{\text{idx}}$ | Indexed<br>$y^{\text{idx}}$ | $z^{\text{idx}}$ | Permuted<br>Index |
|--------------------------------------------------|------------------|-----------------------------|------------------|-------------------|
| $\frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial x_A \partial x_B}$ | 2                | 0                           | 0                | 0                 |
| $\frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial x_A \partial y_B}$ | 1                | -1                          | 0                | 1                 |
| $\frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial x_A \partial z_B}$ | 1                | 0                           | -1               | 2                 |
| $\frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial y_A \partial x_B}$ | -1               | 1                           | 0                | 1                 |
| $\frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial y_A \partial y_B}$ | 0                | 2                           | 0                | 0                 |
| $\frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial y_A \partial z_B}$ | 0                | 1                           | -1               | 2                 |
| $\frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial z_A \partial x_B}$ | -1               | 0                           | 1                | 2                 |
| $\frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial z_A \partial y_B}$ | 0                | -1                          | 1                | 2                 |
| $\frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial z_A \partial z_B}$ | 0                | 0                           | 2                | 3                 |

Table 7.2: Permutation of the coordinates for each Hessian element. At first the permutation of the vectors is shown. After that, the change of the elements of a matrix, for example, for the quadrupole moment is shown.

| Hessian | $\frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial x_A \partial x_A}$ | $\frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial x_A \partial y_A}$ | $\frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial x_A \partial z_A}$ | $\frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial y_A \partial x_A}$ | $\frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial y_A \partial y_A}$ | $\frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial y_A \partial z_A}$ | $\frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial z_A \partial x_A}$ | $\frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial z_A \partial y_A}$ | $\frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial z_A \partial z_A}$ |
|---------|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| Vector  |                                                  |                                                  |                                                  |                                                  |                                                  |                                                  |                                                  |                                                  |                                                  |
| x       | x                                                | y                                                | z                                                | x                                                | y                                                | z                                                | x                                                | y                                                | z                                                |
| y       | y                                                | x                                                | x                                                | y                                                | z                                                | y                                                | z                                                | z                                                | x                                                |
| z       | z                                                | -z                                               | y                                                | z                                                | x                                                | -x                                               | -y                                               | x                                                | y                                                |
| Matrix  |                                                  |                                                  |                                                  |                                                  |                                                  |                                                  |                                                  |                                                  |                                                  |
| xx      | xx                                               | yy                                               | zz                                               | xx                                               | yy                                               | zz                                               | xx                                               | yy                                               | zz                                               |
| yy      | xy                                               | xx                                               | xx                                               | yy                                               | zz                                               | yy                                               | zz                                               | zz                                               | xx                                               |
| zz      | xz                                               | zz                                               | yy                                               | zz                                               | xx                                               | xx                                               | yy                                               | xx                                               | yy                                               |
| xy      | xy                                               | xy                                               | xz                                               | xy                                               | yz                                               | yz                                               | xz                                               | yz                                               | xz                                               |
| xz      | xz                                               | -yz                                              | yz                                               | xz                                               | xy                                               | -xz                                              | -xy                                              | xy                                               | yz                                               |
| yz      | yz                                               | -xz                                              | xy                                               | yz                                               | xz                                               | -xy                                              | -yz                                              | xz                                               | xy                                               |